

the hindu businessline

bl portfolio



Currency outlook.
How and why the
changing yield
differentials
will matter
BIG STORY P2



IPO Watch.
Should investors
subscribe to the
NSE public issue?
Our analysis
TAKING STOCK P5

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

The great Indian bull market paradox

CURVEBALL. For a duration that covers 77% of this bull market, benchmark indices and quite a number of stocks have delivered underwhelming returns compared to FDs

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

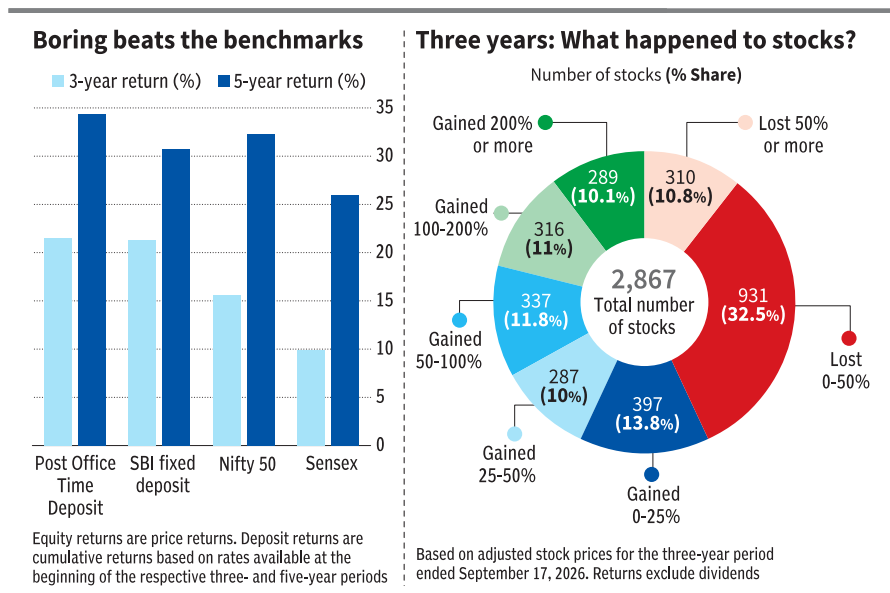
The ongoing bull market, now 2,370 days old, is the longest-running in India, yet it may not feel so for many who entered Dalal Street for the first time in recent years. For years, stock market investors had little patience for fixed deposits. Equities were the place to be, every dip was an opportunity, and an FD yielding 6-7 per cent looked like financial furniture: Safe, familiar and thoroughly unexciting. Turns out, the financial furniture not only held up, but also outperformed much of the fancy decor!

For the three-year period ended September 17, 2026, the Nifty 50 gained 15.58 per cent and the Sensex just 9.94 per cent on a price-return basis. A three-year SBI FD available at the start of this period at 6.5 per cent would have generated a cumulative return of about 21.34 per cent. The three-year Post Office Time Deposit, then carrying 7 per cent interest, did a little better, at about 21.56 per cent.

The discomfort does not disappear even over five years. Since September 2021, the Nifty 50 has gained about 32.3 per cent, narrowly ahead of the roughly 30.8 per cent return from a five-year SBI FD, but below the 34.4 per cent return of a five-year Post Office Time Deposit. These five years account for 77 per cent of the current bull market's duration and underline the market's eccentricities. Even a small dip from current Nifty levels would push its five-year price return below the SBI FD hurdle rate as well. For a bull market, losing to an SBI FD and a Post Office deposit is the sort of embarrassment the bulls could do without.

BORING WINS

The indices are not alone. A *bl.portfolio* analysis of over 2,800 stocks for which comparable adjusted price data were available shows that 1,595, or 56 per cent, failed to beat the three-year Post Office deposit return. Almost the same proportion failed to beat the SBI FD too. More strikingly, 1,241 stocks, or about 4 in 10, lost money over these three



years. The median stock gained just 11.25 per cent, half the return generated by the Post Office deposit. This should not, however, be mistaken for a market where nobody made money. D-Street had its fireworks. About 605 stocks, or 21 per cent of the universe, at least doubled. Of these, 289 stocks tripled or more. This highlights how much stock selection, discretion and

valuation mattered, rather than mindless euphoria. That is also what makes the period unusual. More than two out of five stocks destroyed capital, while one in five became multibaggers. So, D-Street served a few investors a bit of *pulao* while many others were left looking for the *papad*.

WINNERS' ENCLOSURE
Sector performance shows

how selective the rally was. Defence, non-ferrous metals, healthcare and capital goods saw broad participation, while IT, FMCG, cement, logistics and several consumer-facing pockets struggled. Some heavy-weight names help explain why the headline indices struggled. Of the ten largest companies by market capitalisation in September 2023, only four beat the Post Of-

fice hurdle rate. TCS fell about 39 per cent, ITC 38 per cent, Infosys 29 per cent and HUL 20 per cent. HDFC Bank lost about 12 per cent, while RIL returned barely 2 per cent. Being a bellwether was no protection against being shown up by the neighbourhood post office or bank FD. Against that stood Bharti Airtel, up about 99 per cent, SBI at 63 per cent, ICICI Bank at 36 per cent and Bajaj Finance at 35 per cent.

This was not simply a case of large-caps failing while smaller stocks partied. The top 100 stocks by September 2023 market capitalisation delivered a median return of about 31 per cent, with 58 per cent beating the Post Office. The odds worsened progressively down the market-cap ladder. Among stocks ranked beyond 1,000, the three-year median return was only about 8 per cent, just 42 per cent beat the Post Office and nearly 46 per cent lost money. So the problem was not large-caps generally.

BULL GETS SELECTIVE
Between September 2021 and September 2023, the

median stock in this universe gained about 39 per cent, with nearly 73 per cent of stocks in the green. Over the subsequent three years, the median return shrank to 11.25 per cent and the share of gainers fell to about 57 per cent. Almost 30 per cent of the universe comprises stocks that rose in the earlier two-year period but fell over the next 3 years.

The data partly explain the strange optics of the current market. Since the March 2020 bottom, the Nifty has seen only four drawdowns exceeding 10 per cent, despite the bull phase stretching for over six years. But underneath that calm, outcomes were sharply dispersed. None of this means FDs should replace equities for all investors. But the numbers puncture a casual assumption: that staying invested through a bull market guarantees a premium over deposits. Over the last 3 years, the boring instruments did their job. A majority of stocks did not! Ignoring the need for a margin of safety in equities can have painful consequences, as the last 3 to 5 years have shown.

INVESTMENT. FOCUS

United Breweries: Accumulate

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Investors with a three-to-five-year horizon can accumulate shares of United Breweries (UBL) following the stock's 29 per cent correction since our March 2026 review, which has materially improved the risk-reward.

At around ₹1,249, trailing EV/EBITDA has fallen from around 61 times then to 41 times, while its blended-forward multiple of 30.7 times is 20 per cent below its five-year average. Operating trends are improving, too, with Q1FY27 sell-in volumes growing 9 per cent and consumer offtake 13 per cent. Premiumisation continues to gain traction, while localisation, productivity measures and a better State mix offer scope for margin improvement. With valuations now more reasonable and several operating levers falling in place, the current correction offers a better entry point for investors willing to take a medium-term view.

Details p5

ASIAN SPORTS EXTRAVAGANZA



MARCHING TO GLORY. India's double Olympic medallist Manu Bhaker and kabaddi player Pawan Sehrawat lead the Indian contingent during the athletes' parade at the opening ceremony of the 20th Asian Games at Nagoya's Mizuho Park Stadium on Saturday. Japanese Emperor Naruhito declared open the sporting extravaganza that will run until October 4 across Aichi-Nagoya, Japan

45 MoUs signal India's emergence as chip hub

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

The three-day Semicon India 2026 saw 45 memoranda of understanding (MoUs) and agreements signed, with the government indicating that the next edition could be significantly larger, with electronics companies using 'Made in India' chips also expected to participate.

The next edition of Semicon is tentatively scheduled for March 2028, said Ajit Manocha, President and CEO of Semiconductor Equipment and Materials International (SEMI).

"Collaboration is a very good thing. Next Semicon again is going to be a bigger thing, maybe in partnership with electronics companies and India Mobile Congress (IMC) as well. So, you will see a mega event next time



STRONG INTEREST. Over 600 companies participated in this edition of Semicon India, up from 350 companies last time

and a lot of arrangements would be required for that," Amitesh Kumar Sinha, Additional Secretary, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), said at the closing ceremony of Semicon India 2026.

MEETING POINT
Sinha, who is also CEO of the India Semiconductor Mission (ISM), said the pur-

pose of the event was to bring together all ecosystem players to collaborate, forge joint ventures and technology partnerships, and share knowledge.

"It is an opportunity for everybody — students, academia, researchers, stakeholders, partners, entrepreneurs. I am happy to note that the kind of participation we have seen after the an-

nouncement of the Semicon 2.0 policy... 600 companies against 350 companies last time. Of these, 300 were international companies, which really shows the tremendous momentum being generated around the policies," Sinha added.

MOMENTUM BUILDS

According to Ashok Chandak, President, India Electronics and Semiconductor Association (IESA) and SEMI India, Semicon India received close to 50,000 registrations this year, with around 40,000 cumulative footfalls over the three days.

"Over these three days, one message was clear: India initially moved from policies to execution, and now India is moving from action to momentum... Investors are looking and exploring what's happening in the country, and how and where they can

invest. Global companies are looking at areas where they can expand their businesses, startups are looking at innovations, and academia is looking at R&D activities... It's a powerful message that I see," Chandak added.

Meanwhile, EY and IESA also launched a report, *Semicon India 2.0: From Capacity Creation to Ecosystem Leadership*, which projects India's semiconductor market growing from nearly \$64 billion in 2026 to \$200 billion by 2035.

Consumer electronics, automotive and industrial applications account for 30 per cent, 16 per cent and 15 per cent, respectively, of India's semiconductor market.

The report also indicated that AI, data centres, telecommunications, electric mobility and advanced manufacturing are opening up new growth avenues.

NDDB rolls out kits to detect adulteration in milk

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

The National Dairy Development Board (NDDB) has launched a milk adulteration detection kit capable of identifying five common adulterants — starch, neutraliser, urea, sugar and salt — as part of its effort to strengthen milk quality testing across the dairy supply chain.

NDDB has developed two variants of the kit and begun manufacturing them, with production capacity scalable to 1,000 units a month. The larger variant can detect nine adulterants — hydrogen peroxide, starch, glucose, nitrate, sugar, neutraliser, ammonium fertilisers and urea, official sources at NDDB told *businessline* on Saturday.

WIDER TESTING

The kit is designed to make milk adulteration testing more convenient and cost-effective, potentially en-

abling wider quality checks across the dairy network. The need for faster and more widespread testing has also been underscored by recent enforcement action.

On February 14, Food Safety officials and the Local Crime Branch inspected a milk collection centre in Maharashtra's Ahilyanagar district and seized suspected adulterants and milk stocks. Samples sent for testing on February 16 were subsequently found to contain mineral oil, detergent and neutraliser. The centre's registration under the Food Safety and Standards Act was cancelled, while three accused were taken into police custody.

The launch comes amid continued enforcement action against adulteration in milk and milk products. Cases lodged for violations related to milk and milk products increased from 10,623 in FY23 to 12,057 in FY25, up nearly 14 per cent, according to data tabled in

Parliament in August 2025. Penalties imposed increased by over 50 per cent, from ₹24.3 crore to ₹36.72 crore during the same period, underscoring the need for quicker and more accessible testing mechanisms across the dairy supply chain.

PROCUREMENT

The milk testing kit was among three farmer-centric initiatives unveiled by NDDB on Friday. The other launches included a 300-litre mobile milk collection and cooling system and DARPAN, an integrated document management system.

The mobile milk collection system is designed to address one of the key challenges in expanding organised milk procurement — bringing collection and cooling infrastructure closer to rural producers. The lithium-ion battery-operated 300-litre system, developed by NDDB and manufactured by its wholly owned subsidiary IDMC Ltd, combines

milk collection, weighing, quality testing and receipt generation in a single mobile unit.

The system also comes with an IoT-enabled monitoring facility, allowing milk collection and cooling operations to be tracked digitally. The mobile format could help dairy co-operatives extend organised procurement to areas where setting up conventional collection and cooling infrastructure may be difficult.

DARPAN, the third initiative, is an integrated document management system being implemented at NDDB. The digital platform is part of NDDB's wider push to modernise its internal processes and improve document and information management.

Union Dairy Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh, who launched the initiatives at NDDB's headquarters in Anand, called for their large-scale implementation and commercialisation.

Donald Trump extends \$100,000 fee on H-1B visas by a year, tightens scrutiny

Press Trust of India
Washington

US President Donald Trump has extended by a year the \$100,000 fee on employers for bringing in foreign workers on H-1B visas, the White House said.

In a presidential proclamation issued on Friday, Trump said the 2025 decision to impose a \$100,000 fee had led to a 92 per cent decrease in H-1B registrations by large IT outsourcing firms.

"An extension of the 2025 Proclamation will continue to protect the economic and national security interests of the United States, improve labour market access for American workers and graduates, and ensure that employers recruit only the most highly-skilled and essential alien workers when needed in line with the ori-

ginal intent of the programme," Trump said.

KEY BENEFICIARY

Indians remain the single largest beneficiary group of the US H-1B visa programme.

The 2025 decision to levy the \$100,000 fee has run into a legal challenge and the matter is before two different federal courts.

The 2025 order for a fee hike was set to expire this month. It did not apply to visas granted to foreign citizens already in the United States on student visas, who make up a large share of new H-1B recipients, or to renewals of current visas. The order also sets a 30-day deadline for the Secretary of Labour, acting through the Wage and Hour Division, to begin reviewing data from previously submitted labour condition applications.

The review will deter-



US President Donald Trump

ine whether further action against sponsoring employers is warranted.

TIGHTER SCRUTINY

The President also issued a separate proclamation, tightening the scrutiny of H-1B visa applications through better inter-agency co-operation.

"The Order enhances program integrity in the H-1B visa program by improving inter-agency coordination and directing enhanced scrutiny of H-1B visa applications where there is a

heightened risk that American workers would be laid off," a fact-sheet issued by the White House said. The Order directs the Secretary of State, the Secretary of Labour, and the Secretary of Homeland Security to consider petitioner employers' recent or planned lay-offs of similarly situated US workers when considering H-1B visa applications.

The H-1B non-immigrant visa programme was created to identify uniquely skilled and highly specialised foreign temporary workers to strategically supplement the United States economy, the US President said in the executive order. "Instead, the programme has been widely abused by certain employers, third-party placement groups, and outsourcing firms to undercut and displace the supply of skilled United States labour," Trump said.

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl, research bureau

Quant-based equity mutual funds use mathematical models and data-driven rules to build portfolios. They occupy a small corner of the Indian mutual fund industry. The category has just 11 schemes managing around ₹11,700 crore, with only two having a track record of more than seven years, as most were launched after 2021.

Asset Management Companies (AMCs) appear reluctant to push the category aggressively. Indian fund houses have traditionally built their equity businesses around star fund managers, large research teams and discretionary stock-picking. Quant investing, by contrast, requires a different investment architecture, combining large datasets, quantitative models and specialised technology. Consequently, only a handful of AMCs have made quant investing a meaningful part of their equity offerings.

With returns from these funds so far being uneven and largely inconsistent, the real question is: Is quant investing genuinely a better way to pick stocks? Is it simply another investment philosophy yet to prove its worth? Let’s take a detailed look.

QUANT INVESTING

In traditional active equity funds, fund managers and research teams analyse companies, assess market conditions and make investment decisions based on their judgement. Quant funds, on the other hand, use data, mathematical models and predefined rules to select stocks and construct portfolios.

Quant strategies attempt to reduce behavioural biases by following a predefined and typically backtested investment process, with limited human intervention.

However, like any other strategy, quant investing is not a sure-shot ticket to superior returns. The success of any quant strategy ultimately depends on whether the factors and signals embedded in its model continue to work across changing market environments.

FACTORS

Quant funds use predefined factors such as value, quality, momentum, low volatility and growth to identify stocks. Their models systematically score

The jury is still out on quant-based funds

STRATEGY MATTERS. Factor choices, rebalancing rules and human intervention shape risk and returns across quant schemes



stocks on these factors and select or weight them according to the fund’s strategy. Many quant funds combine multiple factors rather than relying on a single one, seeking to build more diversified and robust portfolios.

Momentum favours recent price winners, often with returns adjusted for volatility.

Quality screens for profitability, earnings stability, cash flows and manageable debt.

Value seeks stocks that look inexpensive on measures such as P/E, P/B and dividend yield.

Low volatility favours stocks with lower historical price fluctuations.

Growth favours companies with strong, consistent sales, profit or cash-flow growth.

We analysed the portfolio composition, quantitative models, factors and key metrics used by these funds to construct and manage their portfolios. However, disclosure of proprietary models remains limited.

The analysis throws up several interesting findings:

From factor investing to factor engineering: Many funds are moving beyond the conventional value-quality-momentum-low-volatility framework. 360 ONE, for example, combines momentum with filters for secular, cyclical and defensive characteristics, while also explicitly seeking to avoid value traps. Aditya Birla incorporates sell-side earnings revisions, while Quant Quanta-

TAKEAWAYS

- Momentum features across most quant strategies
- Some models retain human judgment
- Returns remain uneven across funds

mental combines quantitative and fundamental screens.

Kotak takes a layered approach. Momentum is used for initial stock selection, quality then filters out weaker companies, and low volatility is finally used to determine position weights.

Combining models with human judgment: Although models drive the investment process, most funds still leave some room for human intervention. Quant Quantamental is a clear example, combining quantitative signals with fundamental inputs in a hybrid approach.

Factor rotation: While many funds use a relatively consistent set of factors to build and reconstruct their portfolios, ICICI Prudential’s model is described as dynamic, allowing factor exposures to rotate over time.

Same benchmark, but different risk profiles: While quant funds typically use either the BSE 200 or Nifty 200 as their benchmark, their market-cap allocations vary sharply. An analysis of the average market-cap

allocation over the past year, broken down into large-, mid- and small-cap stocks, shows that Nippon India Quant held 84 per cent in large-caps. Quant Quantamental and Kotak Quant were more balanced, with 56 per cent and 54 per cent in large-caps, respectively. Motilal Oswal Quant, meanwhile, has shown a greater willingness to shift across market-cap segments. At one point, it held 76 per cent in small-cap stocks in September 2024. Thus, while the benchmark provides a broad reference point, the model determines the portfolio’s actual risk profile. Motilal Oswal Quant also has leeway to allocate a portion of the portfolio outside model-driven selections.

Momentum dominates: Momentum appears either as a primary factor or as a critical component of nearly every major quant strategy analysed, including funds from 360 ONE, Aditya Birla, DSP, Kotak, Nippon, SBI and UTI. Interestingly, each fund uses momentum differently. Some employ it as the primary stock-selection engine, while others combine it with quality filters or low-volatility overlays. The prominence of momentum also highlights one of the key risks of quant investing: a strategy that works strongly during one market phase can reverse sharply when market leadership changes.

Rebalancing speed: As per the fund presentation notes, Axis, DSP, Motilal Oswal and SBI

Quant rebalance monthly, while Aditya Birla and Nippon India Quant rebalance quarterly. Frequent rebalancing allows a model to respond faster to changes in its underlying signals. However, it can also increase portfolio turnover and transaction costs.

WHAT SHOULD YOU DO

Not all quant funds are created equal. Their investment approaches differ significantly, making them distinct investment engines rather than a homogeneous category.

For instance, 360 ONE Quant places greater emphasis on momentum, while Axis Quant gives relatively higher weight to quality and value. Aditya Birla SL Quant gives equal importance to its factors, whereas Nippon India and SBI Quant dynamically allocate across factors. Aditya Birla SL Quant and Quant Quantamental combine man and machine, using quantitative models alongside fund-manager judgement.

Therefore, investors should look beyond the “quant” label. What matters is the investment engine under the hood. Examine the factors used, how they are combined, how frequently the portfolio is rebalanced, the market-cap exposure created by the model, and how much human judgement remains in the process.

Secondly, no single factor works all the time, nor does any combination of factors guarantee consistent outperformance. Momentum can crash, value can remain dormant for years, growth can become overvalued, quality can lag during speculative rallies, and low volatility can underperform in rapidly rising markets.

Multi-factor investing recognises that market leadership can change over time. When one factor struggles, another may compensate, potentially making the overall strategy more resilient. But multi-factor investing is not a free pass either. Combining factors can reduce dependence on a single source of return, but it does not eliminate factor risk.

Above all, returns from these funds have so far been uneven across schemes and periods. Only two funds have a track record of more than seven years. A five-year rolling-return analysis over the last seven-year period shows that Nippon India delivered an average CAGR of 20 per cent, outperforming the Nifty 200 Total Return Index’s 17.5 per cent. In contrast, DSP Quant lagged, with a 12.5 per cent CAGR.

Among funds with a shorter track record, Quant Quantamental delivered relatively better returns over the one-, three- and five-year periods, while 360 ONE Quant and Kotak Quant did better over the three-year period.

The category’s short history offers limited evidence across market cycles, while wide return dispersion shows that the “quant” label alone says little. Outcomes depend on factor selection, model design and the strategy’s ability to adapt to changing markets.

Investors should look beyond the “quant” label, understand each fund’s investment engine and evaluate its performance across market cycles.

ALERTS.

Kotak Nifty Capital Markets Index Fund new offering



Kotak Mahindra Asset Management Company has launched the Kotak Nifty Capital Markets Index Fund, an open-ended scheme replicating/tracking the Nifty Capital Markets Index. The new fund offer will close on September 29. The Kotak Nifty Capital Markets Index Fund offers investors a passive way to participate in this broader theme through a single fund. The minimum application amount in the NFO of the scheme is ₹1,000.

SEBI chairman urges Army personnel to invest with discipline



SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey, at a specialised Investor Awareness Programme recently organised by the Association of Mutual Funds in India for the Army personnel at Leh, urged them to approach investing with the same discipline, preparedness and vigilance with which they serve the country. The programme was attended by about 500 Army personnel, including commissioned officers and *javans*. He said investment decisions should be aligned with an investor’s financial needs, family responsibilities and risk-taking capacity.

ETF movers

	NAV (₹)	Price (₹)	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
as on Sep 18				
ETF				
Motilal Oswal Nasdaq Q50	118.1	396.3	83.2	5,557
Mirae Asset S&P 500 Top 50	67.9	124.5	32.5	8,932
Mirae Asset NYSE FANG+	176.5	248.1	5.3	4,183
DSP Nifty Midcap 150 ETF	23.0	23.8	3.8	61
Quant Silver ETF	23.7	23.8	3.7	332
Bandhan Silver ETF	235.3	235.5	3.6	85
DSP Silver ETF	22.6	22.6	3.6	21,120
GOLD ETFs				
Invesco India Gold ETF	132.5	133.8	1.4	135
Bandhan Gold ETF	152.1	153.2	1.3	91
Baroda BNP Paribas Gold ETF	147.5	148.0	1.2	24

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on September 18, 2026

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR						
Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on Sep 18	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)	
		3-year	5-year	10-year		
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS						
HDFC Pension Fund	52.7	8.6	8.5	12.3	84,399	
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	72.9	9.8	9.6	12.2	32,619	
Kotak Pension Fund	65.9	8.8	9.2	12.0	4,874	
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS						
LIC Pension Fund	31.3	6.5	5.8	7.6	9,328	
SBI Pension Fund	41.9	6.5	5.8	7.1	31,577	
HDFC Pension Fund	28.7	6.1	5.5	7.0	57,211	
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS						
HDFC Pension Fund	30.9	7.7	6.7	7.9	36,660	
SBI Pension Fund	46.7	7.7	6.5	7.6	16,782	
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	46.5	7.6	6.5	7.6	14,933	
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS						
HDFC Pension Fund	45.8	8.9	8.7	12.3	1,920	
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	57.5	9.5	9.5	12.2	865	
Kotak Pension Fund	58.0	8.8	9.2	12.0	233	

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on September 18, 2026

Same “quant” label, very different investment engines

Fund	Return (CAGR %)				Benchmark	Average number of stocks*	Large / Mid / Small (%)**	Key factors / signals
	1-year	3-year	5-year	7-year				
360 ONE Quant	-6.2	12.9	-	-	BSE 200	37	62 / 38 / 0	Momentum-led; cyclical & defensive filters; value-trap filter
Aditya Birla SL Quant	3.5	-	-	-	Nifty 200	43	58 / 40 / 1	Quality, momentum, earnings revisions & low volatility
Axis Quant	-0.7	6.7	7.2	-	BSE 200	33	74 / 19 / 1	High beta, liquidity & volatility
DSP Quant	-5.3	5.2	3.5	11.8	BSE 200	40	66 / 31 / 0	Value, quality, momentum & growth
ICICI Pru Quant	-2.9	10.0	9.6	-	BSE 200	54	67 / 24 / 3	Multi-factor; factor weights can rotate dynamically
Kotak Quant	-1.4	12.8	-	-	Nifty 200	55	54 / 38 / 5	Momentum for selection; quality filter; low volatility for weighting
Motilal Oswal Quant	-4.3	-	-	-	Nifty 200	52	33 / 47 / 25	Profitability compared with market-cap-based valuation
Nippon India Quant	-2.3	12.3	12.2	16.7	BSE 200	35	84 / 14 / 0	Value, growth, momentum, quality & low volatility
Quant Quantamental	8.2	13.2	17.3	-	Nifty 200	15	56 / 14 / 2	Quant + fundamental; valuation, liquidity, risk appetite & time
SBI Quant	-3.7	-	-	-	Nifty 200	30	67 / 31 / 0	Momentum, value, quality & growth
UTI Quant	-6.0	-	-	-	BSE 200	81	68 / 23 / 5	Momentum-led; low volatility, quality & value
Nifty 200 TRI	-3.3	9.0	8.9	14.6	-	-	-	-

*Calculated from the last one year portfolio data. **May not add up to 100%, as large-, mid- and small-cap allocations are averaged separately over the past year. Source: Presentation of respective funds. ACEMF Value as of Sep 17, 2026

A model-driven approach to market cycles

FUND CALL. Baroda BNP Paribas Balanced Advantage’s quantitative, counter-cyclical asset allocation has worked well

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl, research bureau

Baroda BNP Paribas Balanced Advantage Fund (BBAF) has been one of the top-performing funds in the Balanced Advantage Fund category. It has received a 5-star rating from the *blportfolio* Mutual Fund Ratings ever since it became eligible for a rating. Launched in November 2018, it has delivered a compounded annualised return of 13 per cent.

Balanced Advantage Funds offer the flexibility to shift between equity and debt based on market conditions, valuations, interest rates and proprietary models. They also use arbitrage strategies to mitigate volatility. This adaptability can help limit downside risk during volatile phases. These funds generally maintain gross equity exposure of at least 65 per cent, while hedging part of it through derivatives, to qualify for equity taxation.

FOUR-FACTOR MODEL

The fund follows a quantitative, counter-cyclical approach to asset allocation. A counter-cyclical approach means increasing equity exposure when markets are fearful and valuations are attractive, while reducing it when markets are euphoric and valuations become

stretched. Its proprietary model determines the fund’s net equity exposure, which can range from around 40 per cent to as high as 90 per cent.

The fund’s proprietary model uses four key factors: P/E, P/B, dividend yield and the relative attractiveness of equity versus debt. P/E captures market valuations relative to earnings, while P/B assesses valuations against book value. The model uses dividend yield as a valuation and quality signal, based on the premise that sustainable payouts generally require healthy cash generation and balance-sheet strength. The fourth factor compares earnings yield, the inverse of P/E, with the sovereign yield to determine whether equity or debt offers greater relative attractiveness.

The four factors are not equally weighted. Their broad weights are 20 per cent for P/E, 20 per cent for P/B, 30 per cent for dividend yield and 30 per cent for the earnings-yield gap versus sovereign yields. Thus, cash generation and the relative attractiveness of equities over debt carry greater weight in the model. The model is recalibrated generally around the 20th-22nd of every month, with the target allocation achieved before the month’s F&O expiry. The fund manager has only a two-percentage-point leeway around the model’s prescribed

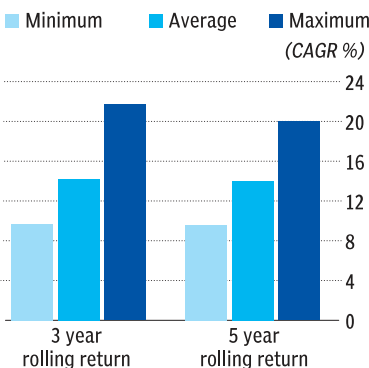


SALIENT FEATURES

- Counter-cyclical model drives equity allocation
- Stock selection favours faster-growing businesses
- Debt allocation cushions portfolio volatility

allocation, primarily to accommodate daily market movements and investor flows. This asset-allocation strategy has helped the fund deliver relatively better returns than its peers. In the aftermath of the Covid-19 sell-off in 2020, the model indicated net equity exposure of around 87 per cent, even as investor sentiment was extremely weak. Over the past five years, equity exposure has broadly moved

How the fund performed on rolling return basis



The chart illustrates the fund’s performance based on 3-year and 5-year rolling returns calculated from the last seven years NAV history, highlighting the minimum, average, and maximum returns achieved over these periods. Source: ACEMF Value as of Sep 17, 2026

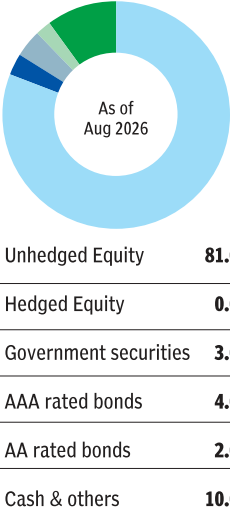
between 40 per cent and 88 per cent.

The model currently indicates around 81 per cent net equity exposure, as valuations have fallen below their long-term median. The signal, therefore, remains bullish on equities.

STOCK SELECTION

The fund looks for sectors expected to grow faster than the broader market and, within those sectors,

Portfolio asset class break-up (%)



companies that can grow faster than the sector median. Around one-third of the equity portfolio is typically invested in mid- and small-caps, with the remaining two-thirds in large caps.

The fund is overweight compared to benchmark on capital goods, power equipment, defence and pharma. It is underweight financials, particularly large private banks such as HDFC Bank and ICICI Bank, favouring Federal

Bank and SBI instead. BHEL and Hitachi were early bets in electrical equipment and have performed strongly. The fund’s top sector bets include banks, electrical equipment and automobiles. Over the last one year, it increased its allocation to power, chemicals and auto, while reducing exposure to retailing, banks and IT.

ARBITRAGE

Arbitrage is used when the model calls for net equity exposure below the threshold required for an equity-oriented scheme. The arbitrage book is completely separate from the unhedged equity portfolio.

DEBT

The debt allocation is largely a residual of the equity allocation indicated by the fund’s model, but its primary role is to provide liquidity and limit volatility. Average duration is generally kept between two and five years. Credit risk is kept low, with the majority invested in sovereign and AAA-rated securities, while small tactical allocations to AA-rated securities may be made when spreads are attractive. As of August 2026, the fund held 3 per cent in government securities, 4 per cent in AAA-rated bonds and around 2 per cent in AA-rated papers.

The fund’s notable allocation to InvITs has also helped enhance and stabilise returns, as InvITs have delivered attractive returns over the past three years. However, fresh InvIT allocations are currently not permitted under the revised regulatory framework for this category. Over the last one year, its InvIT allocation was reduced to four per cent from seven per cent.

PERFORMANCE

Over the past seven years, its five-year rolling returns averaged 14 per cent CAGR, compared with 11 per cent for the category. During this period, its five-year rolling returns ranged from 9.6 per cent to 20 per cent. On a three-year rolling-return basis, the fund delivered a CAGR of 14.2 per cent, compared with 11.5 per cent for the category average.

The regular plan has a base expense ratio of 1.59 per cent, lower than the category average of 1.7 per cent. The direct plan’s expense ratio is 0.63 per cent, marginally lower than the category average of 0.64 per cent.

This fund is suitable for first-time investors seeking controlled exposure to equity risk as well as investors with a moderate risk profile who want equity-like growth with relatively lower volatility. A minimum investment horizon of three years or more is recommended.

Exchange excitement for patience this time

IPO WATCH. Considering NSE’s high dependence on options business, and valuation at a considerable premium to global peers, investors can wait for better entry points post listing

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

NSE’s (National Stock Exchange) ₹22,562-crore IPO (initial public offering), the second-largest IPO in India, will be open for subscription till September 21.

The offer price band is ₹1,700-1,785 and the issue is entirely an OFS (offer for sale), meaning the company will not receive any proceeds and some of the existing shareholders are partially exiting their investments.

At the upper price band, NSE will command a market capitalisation of about ₹4.4 lakh crore, making it one of the largest listed companies in the domestic market. Based on FY26 EPS (earnings per share) of ₹41.6, the stock is valued at a PE of about 43 times (price-to-earnings or P/E), compared with BSE’s 53 times.

While Multi Commodity Exchange (MCX) is another listed exchange, BSE is the closest comparable given its predominant presence in the equity market, unlike MCX primarily operating in commodities. For reference, MCX is valued at 62 times FY26 P/E.

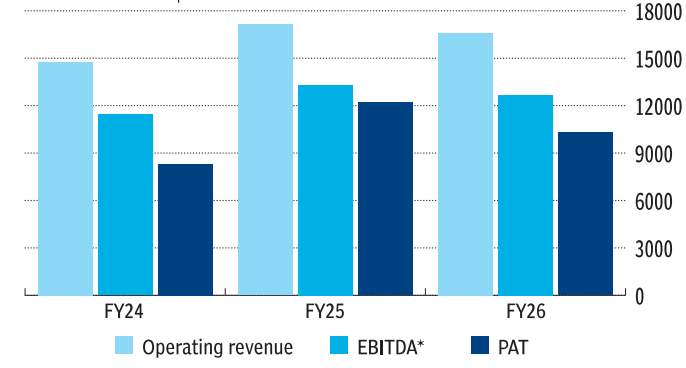
Although NSE remains the dominant exchange in India with over 90 per cent share in India’s equities cash turnover value, at its current valuation it does not offer sufficient margin of safety for new investors for the following reasons.

One, its high dependence on the options segment for around 60 per cent of its revenue, and a majority of it from weekly options is a key concern and factor to monitor. Given the recent SEBI report highlighting the continuing heavy losses (₹91,685 crore in FY26) incurred by retail investors/traders due to trading in options, and risks to market stability posed by huge increases in option positions relative to cash volumes on expiry day, there is a decent possibility for more incremental measures by the regulator/government to temper this trading exuberance. Although there is no clarity now, any incremental measures will impact NSE revenues, as already witnessed in FY26, where its operating revenue declined 3 per cent.

Two, competitor BSE has been gaining market share in this segment.



Financial performance



*NSE's own normalised operating EBITDA Source: Company RHP

Three, the IPO valuation is at a considerable premium to global peers, which have a more diversified revenue mix and have, in fact, delivered much better growth as compared to NSE in the last two years. Therefore, investors can wait out the IPO for now and look for better entry points post listing at a more reasonable valuation

As at close on September 18, the IPO was subscribed 115 per cent.

WHAT NSE DOES

NSE primarily facilitates trading in equity, currency, commodity and debt markets by providing the necessary market infrastructure. Investors cannot trade directly on the exchange and can access it only through registered members, such as stockbrokers.

Apart from transaction charges collected for enabling trades, the exchange has multiple revenue streams. These include connectivity charges (fees for connecting to NSE’s trading system), data feeds and terminals (fees for providing market data such as bid-ask prices and market depth) and data centre rack charges (colocation rentals paid by members to place their servers close to

NSE’s trading engine for faster execution of client orders).

The company also earns from listing services (initial and annual listing fees from companies listed on the NSE), clearing and settlement of trades (through its subsidiary NSE Clearing), and licensing services (fees from licensing Nifty indices to asset managers and other intermediaries).

REVENUE SPLIT

Operating revenue and total income (operating revenue plus other income) stood at ₹16,601 crore and ₹18,713 crore, respectively, in FY26. Of the operating revenue, transaction charges from the cash, futures and options segments together contributed ₹13,057 crore, accounting for nearly 79 per cent. Revenue from options transaction charges alone made up about 60 per cent of the operating revenue.

Non-transaction revenue, comprising connectivity charges, data feeds and terminals, data centre rack charges and licensing services, stood at ₹1,956 crore in FY26, accounting for about 12 per cent of the operating revenue, up from 9 per cent in FY24.

NSE maintains a dominant

IPO rating

NSE	
Business	★★★★★
Financials	★★★★★
Management	★★★★★
Valuation	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★
Rankings 1 to 5, 1 denoting lowest and 5 highest	
Offer period	Sep 17-21, 2026
Price band	₹1,700-1,785
Market capitalisation	₹4.4 lakh cr

market share across most business segments. In FY26, its share in the cash market stood at 93 per cent, while it accounted for 100 per cent of trading in single-stock futures and options. In index derivatives, the exchange achieved a 98.9 per cent market share in futures and 72.1 per cent in options, based on premium turnover.

Globally too, NSE has emerged as a dominant exchange. It ranked first among multi-asset exchange groups with an 11.4 per cent share in global equity cash trade count and a 51.2 per cent share in global equity derivatives contract count in FY26. For Q1FY27, NSE had a global market share of 10.7 per cent in number of trades in cash equities and 50.2 per cent in contracts traded in equity derivatives.

FINANCIALS

Recent performance has been a bit modest — FY24-26 operating revenue CAGR was in the mid-single digits at 6 per cent. Operating EBITDA which was at ₹11,098 crore in FY26, has grown at an even-lower CAGR of 5 per cent. EBITDA margin was at 67 per cent. Profit after tax (PAT) came in at ₹10,302 crore in FY26 and two-year CAGR was 11 per cent. While EBITDA reflects operating performance, PAT includes benefit of growth in other income also, which consists of interest and dividend income.

FY26 numbers were impacted by one-off items. During the year, NSE made a provision of ₹1,432 crore towards settlement of SEBI’s colocation and dark fibre cases, which weighed on the reported EBITDA. Excluding this, the company’s normalised EBITDA margin stood at 76.2 per cent in FY26. Hence while the re-

BSE’s lower rates a competitive threat

Segment	NSE	BSE
Cash	₹307/cr	₹375/cr
Equity futures	₹183/cr	Nil
Equity options	₹3,553/cr premium	₹500/cr premium
Equity options - Sensex and Bankex	NA	₹3,250/cr premium

Note: NSE charges one uniform rate (₹3,553/cr premium) across all equity options, unlike BSE. Source: NSE, BSE

High dependence on options as a revenue stream

Item	Revenue (₹ cr)	% of revenue from operations
Transaction charges — cash	1,555	9.4
Transaction charges — futures	1,480	8.9
Transaction charges — options	9,998	60.2
Transaction charges — mutual fund & others	25	0.2
Total transaction charges	13,057	78.7
Data connectivity charges	1,129	6.8
Data feed & terminal services	470	2.8
Listing services	352	2.1
Clearing & settlement services	251	1.5
Data centre — rack charges	205	1.2
Licensing services	152	0.9
Others	143	0.9
Other operating revenue	842	5.1
Revenue from operations	16,601	100

Source: Company RHP

ported EBITDA declined over 12 per cent in FY26, the fall in normalised EBITDA was about 5 per cent, still a decline though reflecting the impact of SEBI measures to temper options trading and impact of competition.

On the profit front, FY26 included an exceptional gain of ₹1,201 crore from the partial sale of its stake in NSDL (National Securities Depository Ltd).

RISKS

Transaction charges remain the company’s biggest revenue source, accounting for about 79 per cent of the operating revenue in FY26. Revenue from options transaction charges alone contributed about 60 per cent, indicating considerable concentration risk.

While NSE continues to dominate most market segments, its market share in equity options has been declining. Based on premium turnover, the share fell from 96.86 per cent in FY24 to

87.43 per cent in FY25 and further to 74.71 per cent in FY26. As of the June 2026 quarter, it had further declined to 68.48 per cent, with BSE gaining market share.

BSE’s pricing has aided this shift. It charges nil transaction fee on equity futures and about ₹500 per crore (each side) of premium turnover on most equity options, compared with NSE’s uniform ₹3,503 per crore. Even on its flagship Sensex and Bankex contracts, where BSE charges ₹3,250 per crore, it remains cheaper than NSE’s ₹3,503 per crore. These data are as per the respective exchanges.

Notably, NSE’s revenue per investor has dropped from ₹1,611 in FY24 to ₹1,286 in FY26. While a drop in revenue from transaction charges was a reason, the drop can also be attributed to higher growth in investor base. That said, NSE’s ₹1,286 per investor in FY26 is significantly higher than BSE’s ₹195 per investor.

The main risk is from any potential regulatory changes that could impact trading activity. Since 2024, SEBI has introduced measures such as higher lot sizes, restriction of weekly expiries to one benchmark index per exchange and upfront collection of option premiums. The government too took some steps by increasing securities transaction tax on F&O in 2026 Union Budget.

While both the segments continued to grow in FY25 despite the phased implementation of SEBI’s measures, the impact became visible in FY26 after the regulations took full effect. For NSE, the average daily turnover declined 14.2 per cent in equity futures and 7.7 per cent in equity options (premium turnover) during FY26. When it comes to transaction charges, revenue from options transaction charges declined 1.9 per cent. When the segment that accounts for 60 per cent of revenue is declining, it raises a key concern.

More measures by the regulator/government could mean more impact to revenue till other business segments of NSE become large enough to drive growth. This risk remains a key monitorable.

NSE VS GLOBAL EXCHANGES

NSE valuation is also expensive compared with global peers. Nasdaq, ICE (Intercontinental Exchange) and Cboe Global Markets traded at about 26, 23 and 21 times their trailing twelve-month earnings, respectively, compared with NSE’s 43 times. Similarly, their EV/EBITDA multiples are about 17, 16 and 14 times, whereas NSE is valued at about 33 times.

Notably, this premium comes despite NSE recording relatively slower revenue growth. Over the past two years, revenue of Nasdaq, ICE and Cboe grew at a CAGR of about 10 per cent, 7 per cent and 15 per cent, respectively, compared with about 6 per cent for NSE.

When Nasdaq had revenue like that of NSE, which was in 2011, its market cap was at around \$4 billion versus NSE’s estimated market cap of \$45 billion. These factors also indicate that the current valuation does not offer the margin of safety for new investors.

The froth appears to have finally settled

ALCO BEV. A sharp valuation reset, improving demand and clearer margin levers improve United Breweries’ risk-reward

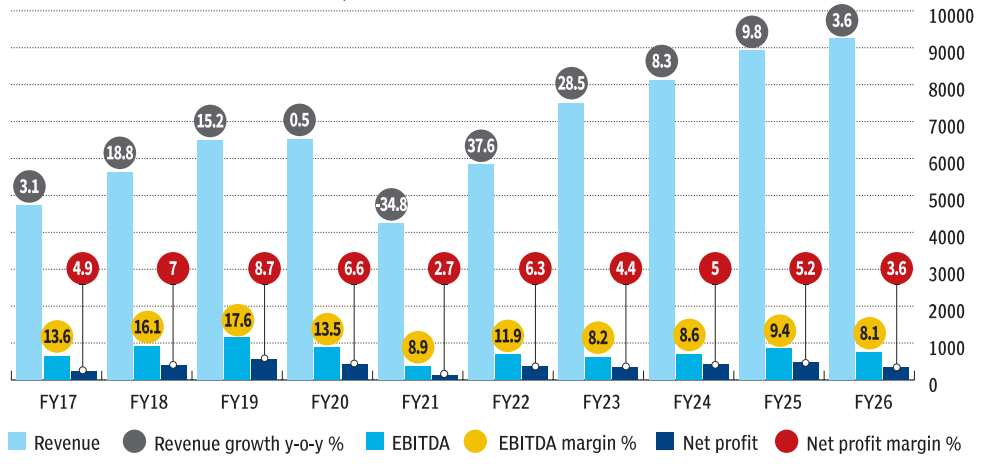
Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

In August 2025, *bl.portfolio* had advised investors of beer giant United Breweries (UBL) to ‘book profits’ when the stock was around ₹1,924, flagging stretched valuations and optimistic earnings expectations. When we revisited UBL in March 2026 at around ₹1,758, we upgraded it to ‘hold’. The risk-reward had improved, but not sufficiently to turn positive. At around 61x trailing EV/EBITDA then, valuations remained demanding while volumes were patchy and the margin improvement seen in Q3FY26 needed to be sustained. We said fresh additions warranted either clearer evidence of sustained earnings and margin improvement or a more meaningful valuation reset. The latter has now happened.

At around ₹1,249, UBL has fallen another 29 per cent since March and is about 46 per cent below the ₹2,299 all-time high (BSE). More importantly, this correction has materially altered the valuation equation. Trailing EV/EBITDA is now around 41 times, about 33 per cent below its March 2026 valuation. Its 12-month blended-forward valuation multiple of 30.7x is also at a 20 per cent discount to its 5-year average of 38.4x. Consensus estimates (Bloomberg) pencil in revenue growth of 10.2 per cent and 11.7 per cent for FY27 and FY28, respectively. Projected EPS growth for FY27 and FY28 are 42 per cent and 51.2 per cent respectively.

Thus, investors getting in today would be paying considerably less for a business where beer demand has strengthened, premiumisation is gaining traction and management has laid out identifiable levers to improve structurally low margins.

How financials stack up



Note: Figures are consolidated; financial metrics are adjusted. Source: Bloomberg

Hence, investors with a medium-term horizon of 3-5 years can start accumulating UBL.

BETTER DEMAND

UBL, controlled by global brewer Heineken, is India’s largest beer maker, with an estimated market share in the high-40s. Kingfisher remains its key franchise, alongside premium offerings. India’s beer opportunity is well known. Per-capita consumption is at just 2.5 litres versus around 25 litres globally. But low penetration has not ensured consistent growth, with weather, State regulation and affordability repeatedly disrupting volumes.

Recent trends are encouraging. FY26 remained subdued, with overall volumes up around 3 per cent, while premium volumes grew 21 per cent. Momentum improved towards year-end, with Q4FY26 sell-in volumes up 4.1 per cent and premium volumes 16 per cent. Q1FY27 was stronger. Sell-in volumes grew 9 per cent, while consumer offtake rose 13 per cent, even as UBL cut channel inventory by around 20 per cent to improve cash flow and fresh-

ACCUMULATE

United Breweries ₹1,248.95

WHY

- Valuation has corrected significantly
- Beer demand showing stronger momentum
- Premium portfolio growing much faster

ness. Underlying consumer demand was therefore stronger than shipment growth suggests. Net sales rose 7 per cent.

Premiumisation continues to outpace the portfolio. Excluding two States where UBL acted to mitigate cost pressures, premium volumes grew 17 per cent in Q1FY27. Heineken Silver grew 28 per cent and Kingfisher Ultra 11 per cent. Premium products have become margin-accretive for the first time, helped by localisation, scale and trade-spend interventions.

MARGIN PUZZLE

Margins remain the weak link in

the UBL story (*see chart*). The decline reflects the pandemic disruption initially, followed by higher input and packaging costs, constrained pricing in regulated markets and elevated spending on brands, bottles and capacity as volumes recovered. FY26 did not establish a decisive turnaround. Premium volumes grew strongly and gross margins improved, but higher opex meant the improvement did not fully flow through to EBITDA.

The near term carries a fresh complication. Middle East-related disruption has raised costs across energy, freight, aluminium used in beer cans. UBL had initially estimated a ₹400-500 crore impact over two-three quarters and is responding through pricing, sourcing and productivity measures. Inflationary pressures could persist. FY27 earnings could remain noisy. Investors should not value UBL as though its margin recovery has already arrived.

BUILDING BLOCKS

There are four principal levers. First is premiumisation. Premium beer grew 2.8 times faster than the overall category

during 2022-25. Premium products also offer the potential for better economics as localisation improves. Second is State mix. UBL groups markets into low-, mid- and high-margin buckets, with gross margins ranging from 25-35 per cent at the lower end to 50-65 per cent at the higher end. A better mix can meaningfully lift margins. Category growth also accelerated after policy changes in Maharashtra, Jharkhand and Karnataka.

Third is productivity. UBL is targeting 100 per cent local sourcing of malt and bottles, has long-term agreements for key inputs, and is localising production to reduce freight and import costs. Its supply footprint comprises 17 active owned breweries and 18 co-packers. Fourth is execution at the point of sale. Store coverage has increased 1.6 times over two years, it now has over 50,000 coolers and draught deployment has increased 2.3 times.

VALUATION RESET

Understand the valuation context. UBL’s current last 12-month EV/EBITDA is around 41 times. Global brewers AB InBev, Constellation Brands, Ambev and Kirin are at roughly 7-11 times current EV/EBITDA. But the domestic comparison is less demanding than it was in March. UBL is now below United Spirits’ roughly 43 times and well below Radico Khaitan’s 59 times. There are still risks. Danish brewer Carlsberg’s aggressive push through Tuborg could intensify competition and trade spending. Raw-material inflation can delay margin recovery. Regulation remains State-dependent, and weather can distort beer demand. Above all, UBL still has to demonstrate that strong premium growth and its productivity programme can sustainably lift EBITDA margins.

businessline’s editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — **Editor**

How sectoral indices moved

	Sept 11	Sept 18	Movement	% change
HEALTHCARE	51,238.1	51,438.3	▲	0.4
OIL&GAS	25,596.4	25,651.1	▲	0.2
FMCG	17,169.5	17,199.7	▲	0.2
METALS	41,199.2	41,215.4	▲	0.0
TECK	14,751.0	14,732.4	▼	-0.1
AUTO	60,385.2	60,198.1	▼	-0.3
POWER	7,496.6	7,445.9	▼	-0.7
IT	27,823.5	27,612.5	▼	-0.8
BANKEX	64,025.1	63,516.9	▼	-0.8
CAPITAL GOODS	77,540.1	76,861.9	▼	-0.9
PSU	20,265.7	20,082.8	▼	-0.9
REALTY	6,629.4	6,556.3	▼	-1.1
CONSUMER DURABLES	62,332.7	60,245.9	▼	-3.3

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here’s a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- I was founded 40 years ago and became a sick company within 10 years.
- I have had several changes in control that resulted in name changes, but still retain the abbreviation of my initial founders in my corporate identity.
- I recently reached a billion-dollar market capitalisation, thanks to more than five-fold growth over the last five years, but delivered negative returns over the previous 10 years.
- A serial entrepreneur in new-age businesses has become my largest non-controlling shareholder.
- Two members of my six-member board are women. One of them gained experience at top consulting firms after her master’s from an IIM and joined my board recently.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by
UNIFI CAPITAL
Investing With Conviction

Last week’s stock:
HEG
Last week’s winner:
Anupam Singh

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (23,346) and Nifty Bank (56,359) slipped 0.2 per cent and 0.4 per cent over the last week.

Both indices opened last week with a gap-up but failed to sustain and saw a strong sell-off. Although both indices recovered, it could not erase all the losses. The charts show that the bearish bias persists.

Below is an analysis of futures and options data of Nifty 50 and Nifty Bank.

NIFTY 50
Nifty (Sep) futures (23,379) was down 0.5 per cent last week. Notably, the outstanding OI (Open Interest) of this contract dropped 3 per cent during this period and stood at 174 lakh contracts on Friday.

While a drop in price along with a decline in OI indicates that some of the longs made an exit, at a broader level, the index witnessed the arrival of fresh sellers.

That is, the cumulative OI of Nifty futures rose 2 per cent to 224 lakh contracts as the underlying index fell.

That said, the options indicate a neutral sentiment as PCR (Put Call Ratio) of both September and October expiries stood at near 1 on Friday. But going by futures data, weakness in Nifty persists.

The charts reflect the same. There was a sharp intraday fall last Tuesday (Monday was a holiday) despite a positive open and the following recovery lacked conviction.

As we stated last week, the outlook will remain negative so long as the September futures trades below 23,750.

Nevertheless, this does not rule out the possibility of a minor rally to the 23,650-23,750 price band before Nifty futures fall again.

Once the decline resumes, the

Bears retain the edge

F&O TRACKER. Derivatives retain a bearish tilt as recovery attempts struggle for momentum



WEAK OUTLOOK

- Key resistances hold
- Futures indicate bearishness
- Option positioning neutral

contract can drop to 22,800. Support below 22,800 is at 22,600.

On the other hand, in case Nifty futures surpasses 23,750, it can move up to 24,000. A breach

of 24,000 can trigger a rally to 24,500.

Strategy: Sell Nifty (Sep) futures if it rises to 23,650. Place initial stop-loss at 23,825.

When the contract slips to 23,300, after the trade is initiated, revise the stop-loss to 23,500. Book profits at 23,150.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank (Sep) futures (56,527) lost 0.6 per cent last week. Similar to Nifty (Sep) futures, there was a moderation in

outstanding OI – it dropped 6 per cent over the last week to 20.5 lakh contracts.

However, unlike in Nifty 50, the cumulative OI of Nifty Bank futures too fell 2 per cent and it stood at 24.4 lakh contracts on Friday. This along with a decline in the underlying index and the futures indicates long unwinding.

On the other hand, PCR of September option increased from 0.91 to 1 over the last week, showing traders sold comparatively more put options than call options. This is a positive sign because traders sell puts when they are bullish.

Importantly though, the PCR of October options saw a considerable fall from 1.13 to 0.59 over the last week.

This was due to heavy selling of calls, particularly 58000-call of October expiry.

Overall, the derivatives data provides a bearish tilt in sentiment, in line with the charts.

The price action shows that an attempt to rally early last week was blocked by the barrier at 57,000. The chart shows that, even though there was some recovery post the decline, there is a notable selling interest.

However, there is a chance for a temporary uptick to 57,000-57,250 from the current level.

A fresh decline, either from the current level of 56,527 or after a rise to the above-mentioned price region, can drag Nifty Bank futures to 55,550. Support below 55,550 is at 55,000.

Instead, if the September futures surpass the resistance at 57,250 and 57,500, the outlook can become bullish, potentially leading to a rally to 58,500 and 59,000.

Strategy: Traders can short Nifty Bank (Sep) futures if it moves up to 57,150. Place stop-loss at 57,800.

When the contract drops to 56,000, tighten the stop-loss to 56,500. Book profits at 55,600.

Execution risks on butterfly spreads

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. It can be set up either as a net credit spread or as a net debit spread

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy
bl. research bureau

Previously in this column, we discussed the execution costs associated with bull call spread and the differences between setting up basket orders and multi-leg orders for ratio spreads. This week, we discuss the execution risk of setting up multi-leg orders, with specific reference to the butterfly spread.

TECHNOLOGY VS EFFICIENCY
You must be mindful of the execution risks arising from the technology architecture for trading, especially if you are an active options trader. This is primarily important when you place multi-leg orders.

Take butterfly call spread. This involves going long on a lower strike call and a higher strike call and short on a middle strike call. Note that the strikes must be equidistant from each other and in the ratio of 1:2:1, where the

short middle strike is twice the quantity of the long outer strikes.

As an options trader, you are likely to choose between your brokers who offer basket orders and multi-leg orders. Basket orders are trading engines offered by brokers that are also designed to optimise your trade to avail the NSE SPAN spread margin benefits. The flip side is that the trade can expose you to partial fills or alternatively to some slippage costs.

Partial fills can happen when you place a limit order and one or more legs in the butterfly spread is not filled at that price. Slippage costs can occur when you place a market order, and the order is filled at a lower price for short strikes or at a higher price for the long price compared to the price at which the strikes were trading when you placed the order.

A multi-leg order can help you manage this slippage cost but has high likelihood of order rejection. Why? For a butterfly spread, you must select the strikes and



TECH IMPACT

You must be mindful of the execution risks arising from the technology architecture for trading

then mention the net credit or net debit at which you want to execute the spread. Note that butterfly spread can be set up either as a net credit spread or as a net debit spread, depending on the strikes you select. The issue is that your trade can be rejected if NSE is unable to fill your order at your stated net debit or net credit amount. Suffice it to understand that based on NSE's

trading architecture, you can improve the chances of executing your butterfly spread by being mindful of your choice of strikes; wider the strikes, less likely your multi-leg order will be executed at your desired net credit or net debit. Choosing strikes with 100-interval difference on the Nifty Index may be optimal as it balances the likelihood of order execution with decent upside potential.

OPTIONAL READING
A success roundtrip transaction involves four important trading aspects. One, your outlook on an underlying.

Two, knowing the optimal futures/options strategy to apply for the given outlook. Three, that the chosen strategy has a good reward-to-risk ratio. And four, the most efficient way to initiate the trade and complete the roundtrip.

The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments

More gains likely

BULLION CUES. Upside targets remain in sight

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Gold (\$4,378.40/ounce) and silver (\$66.30/ounce) were up 0.7 and 2.7 per cent, respectively. In the domestic market, gold futures (₹1,54,381/10 gm) rose 1 per cent and silver futures (₹2,41,603/kg) was up 2.8 per cent.



MCX-GOLD (₹1,54,381)
Gold (Oct) futures opened and remained flat initially. But later it gained momentum and rallied. This reinforced the strength of the support at ₹1,50,000.

While there is a minor hurdle ahead at ₹1,55,000, we expect gold futures to surpass it and rally to ₹1,67,000.

However, if the bears gain strength and drag gold futures below the base at ₹1,50,000, the outlook can turn bearish for a fall to ₹1,44,000. Support below ₹1,44,000 is at ₹1,40,000.

Trade strategy: Retain the longs that we suggested on gold (Oct) futures at ₹1,52,700 with a stop-loss at ₹1,49,000.

When the contract goes up to ₹1,60,000, revise the stop-loss to ₹1,55,000. Book profits at ₹1,67,000.

MCX-SILVER (₹2,41,603)
Silver (Dec) futures, opened flat and then rallied on the back of the support at ₹2,30,000. The price action shows entry of buyers between ₹2,30,000 and ₹2,31,500.

The contract is expected to surpass the resistance at ₹2,45,000 and extend the upswing to ₹2,60,000. However, in case silver futures decline ₹2,30,000, it can witness a deeper fall, probably to ₹2,18,500.

Trade strategy: We suggested buying silver (Dec) futures at ₹2,37,500. Hold on to this trade and maintain the stop-loss at ₹2,29,000.

When the contract rises to ₹2,50,000, raise the stop-loss to ₹2,42,000. Book profits at ₹2,60,000.

Upside bias holds

CRUDE CHECK. Supports can aid recovery

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Oil prices closed almost flat on a weekly basis. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$103.90/barrel) was down 0.7 per cent whereas crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹9,223/barrel) rose 0.8 per cent.



BRENT FUTURES (\$103.90)
Brent crude futures moderated last week. While it marked a weekly low of \$101.53 on Thursday, it ended the week higher at \$103.90.

Despite the price correction, the overall uptrend remains up. Notable support levels that can help the bulls regain strength are \$101.50 and \$98. The price region between these two levels is a strong support band.

A resumption in rally on the back of the nearby support can lift Brent crude futures to \$115 in the near-term. Resistance above \$115 is at \$130. However, if the support at \$98 is breached, the contract can fall further to the \$92-92.50 price band.

MCX CRUDE OIL (₹9,223)
Crude oil (Oct) futures rallied to

mark a fresh high of ₹9,769 on Tuesday.

However, during the following sessions, the price softened as the rally lost strength.

That said, the overall bull trend is valid and the price drop is a corrective fall.

The contract has a notable support at ₹9,000 followed by a support band of ₹8,750-8,500.

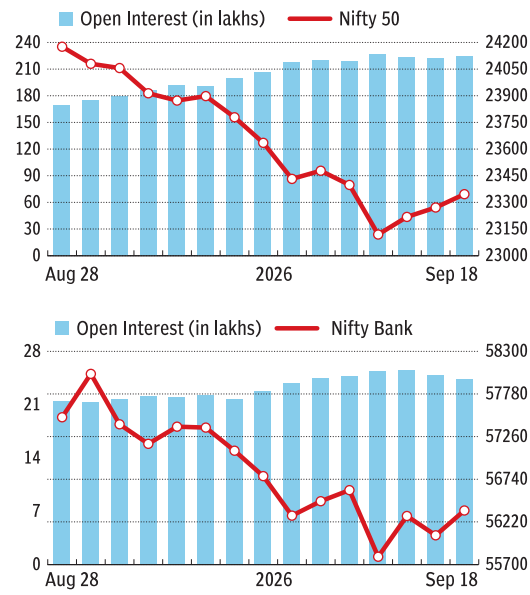
So long as ₹8,500 stays valid, the outlook will be bullish. On the upside, crude oil futures can rally to ₹10,500.

Resistance above ₹10,500 is at ₹11,000.

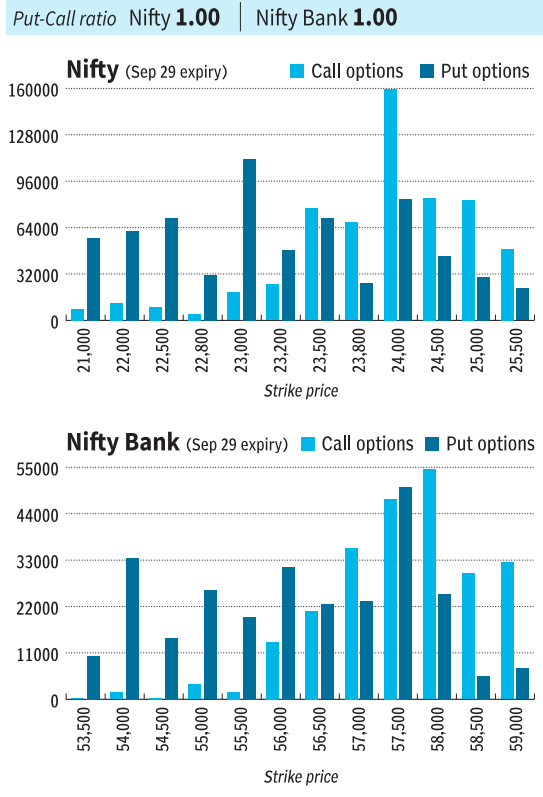
But in case the support at ₹8,500 is breached, the contract can decline to ₹8,000.

Trade strategy: Buy crude oil futures if the price dips to ₹9,000. Target and stop-loss can be ₹10,500 and ₹8,300 respectively.

Cumulative Open Interest (Futures)



Open Interest chain (as on Sep 18)



Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Sep 18	Weekly change %	As on Sep 18	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	48,406	17	297,981	4
Future Index Short	336,834	3	56,561	3
Net Futures	-288,428	1	241,420	4
Index Call options Long	690,977	2	3,604,780	-6
Index Call options Short	959,379	0	3,371,765	-7
Net Call options	-268,402	-7	233,015	1
Index Put options Long	1,299,085	-2	3,094,248	-1
Index Put options Short	668,632	1	3,890,845	0
Net Put Options	630,453	-6	-796,597	6

FII's have cut net short on index calls and reduced net long on index puts. But not much change in net short on index futures. Overall, bearish bias prevails.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Sep 18)				
SOLARINDS	18,555.00	-16.8	48.6	104.5
POLICYBZR	1,743.00	-3.0	145.4	51.0
NESTLEIND	1,372.40	-0.8	201.6	39.1
TCS	2,105.00	-4.4	724.7	32.8
SHREECEM	22,600.00	0.1	7.4	25.8
FALL (as on Sep 18)				
DABUR	395.25	5.1	592.9	-8.3
POLYCAB	8,400.00	1.9	76.2	-7.5
ADANIPORTS	1,824.00	3.4	327.5	-6.1
HDCLIFE	550.95	4.0	928.2	-5.9
BANDHANBNK	175.00	-0.9	1716.4	-5.9

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Sep 21)

BANDHANBNK	INOXWIND	MANAPPURAM	SAIL
------------	----------	------------	------

Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI (Weekly change %)	Indication
COMMODITIES (as on Sep 18)				
ALUMINIUM	30-Sep	353.2 (1.4)	3,163 (-7)	Short covering
COPPER	30-Sep	1,403.1 (1.8)	8,631 (-12)	Short covering
CRUDEOIL	19-Oct	9,223.0 (0.8)	14,056 (150)	Long build-up
CRUDEOILM	19-Oct	9,223.0 (0.8)	35,888 (63)	Long build-up
GOLD	5-Oct	1,54,381.0 (1.0)	8,101 (-16)	Short covering
GOLDGUINEA	30-Sep	1,23,861.0 (0.8)	9,737 (-8)	Short covering
GOLDM	5-Oct	1,54,467.0 (1.0)	31,588 (4)	Long build-up
GOLDPETAL	30-Sep	15,480.0 (0.8)	1,84,129 (-11)	Short covering
GOLDTEN	30-Sep	1,54,617.0 (1.0)	20,605 (-12)	Short covering
LEAD	30-Sep	197.5 (0.6)	717 (8)	Long build-up
NATURALGAS	25-Sep	279.6 (3.7)	23,655 (-57)	Short covering
SILVER	4-Dec	2,41,603.0 (2.8)	11,725 (-12)	Short covering
SILVERM	30-Nov	2,43,146.0 (2.6)	32,070 (-4)	Short covering
SILVERMIC	30-Nov	2,43,126.0 (2.6)	98,233 (-9)	Short covering
ZINC	30-Sep	433.1 (3.4)	2,022 (-19)	Short covering
CURRENCIES (as on Sep 18)				
USDINR	28-Sep	95.97 (0.4)	32,29,497 (12)	Long build-up
EURINR	28-Sep	110.23 (-0.8)	5,452 (9)	Short build-up
GBPINR	28-Sep	128.35 (-0.8)	27,208 (0)	-
JPYINR	28-Sep	60.64 (-2.2)	1,043 (-22)	Long unwinding

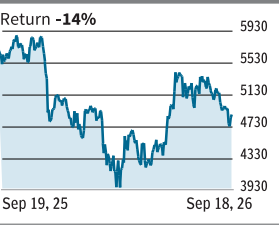
F&O Strategy

Buy IndiGo call option

KS Badri Narayanan

The outlook is positive for InterGlobe Aviation or IndiGo (₹4,920). Resistances are at ₹5,110 and ₹5,426. A break above ₹5,426 can take IndiGo to a new altitude.

Support is at ₹4,733. A close below ₹4,506 will negate the current bull trend. However, we expect the uptrend to sustain.



F&O pointers: IndiGo's September futures closed at ₹4,931.50 against the spot close of ₹4,920. The counter witnessed unwinding of open positions. The open interest declined from 64.64 lakh shares to 60.64 lakh shares as the futures fell from ₹5,120 to ₹4,931.50. However, the premium remains healthy and signals the existence of long positions.

Strategy: Buy 5000-call, which closed at a premium of ₹44.15 on Friday. As the market lot is 150 shares, this would cost traders ₹6,622.50, which would be the maximum loss. That will happen, if IndiGo fails to sustain above ₹5,000.

Keep the stop-loss at ₹25 initially. Shift it to ₹40 if the stock opens on a positive note on Monday. Traders can aim for a target of ₹55-60.

If the stock opens below ₹4,900 or above ₹4,930, trades can ignore this trade. This strategy is valid only for this week.

Follow-up: Contrary to our expectations, Titan Company fell, triggering stop-loss. Recommendations given on SBI Cards (strangle) might have given profit opportunities.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading

Short Take

Why bid-ask spread is key

bl. research bureau

A trade in a stock market, buying or selling of a security, is executed based on the dynamics of demand and supply. The gap or the difference between the highest bid price and lowest ask price defines the spread. It is called as Bid and Ask spread.

Bid price is the price at which a buyer is ready to buy and ask price is at which a seller is ready to sell. When the two points meet, a trade happens.



When bid and ask prices are close, then the spread is small. For instance, the bid price of HDFC Bank 740-strike call option (expiring September 29, 2026) is ₹7.10, the ask price is ₹7.25. A small spread exists when an index or stock is being actively traded with high volume.

On the other hand, when the difference in bid and ask prices are wide, then the spread is said to be relatively large. Consider the case of HDFC Bank's 740-strike call option (expiring November 23, 2026). The bid price is ₹26.95, the ask price is ₹30.20. This indicates that this contract is relatively less actively traded.

While the bid-ask spread has little predictive value price movement, it still plays an important role and retail investors/traders should care to take note of the same. The spread is an indication of not only liquidity of the security but also the accessibility to buy or sell. So, for a trader or an investor, the smaller the spread of a security, the better it is.

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50, Sensex and Nifty Bank index began the week on a volatile note and closed lower on Tuesday. The markets were closed on Monday on account of a public holiday. The gradual rise from Wednesday has aided the benchmark indices to recover some of the loss.

This recovery seems to lack strength. On the charts, the broader picture remains weak. Resistances are there to cap the upside. As such, any further rise from here can be short-lived. We expect the Nifty, Sensex and Nifty Bank index to see more fall going forward.

FPIS SELL

The Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) sold Indian equities for the third consecutive week. The equity segment saw a net outflow of about \$817 million. The net outflow for the month of September now stands at \$2.2 billion.

NIFTY 50 (23,346.40)

Short-term view: Immediate resistance is at 23,500 which can be tested this week. Failure to breach this hurdle can drag the Nifty down to 23,100-23,000. That in turn will keep alive the danger of breaking below 23,000. Such a break can drag the index further lower.

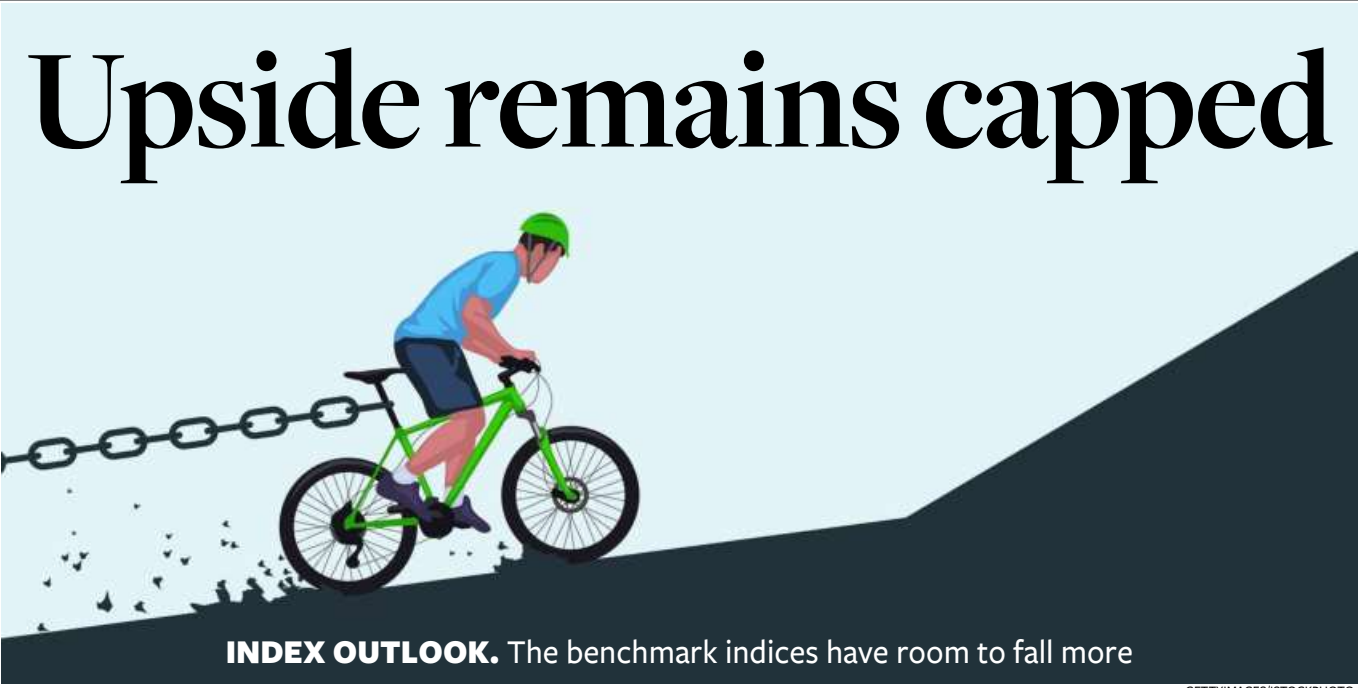
In case the Nifty manages to rise past 23,500 from here, a relief rise to 23,900-24,000 is a possibility. Such a move can reduce the danger of declining below 23,000, but will not completely negate that.

Medium-term view: As mentioned last week, Nifty can fall towards the lower end of its broad 22,000-26,500 range. So, the expected break below 23,000 mentioned above can drag the Nifty down to 22,600-22,500 initially and even lower thereafter.

However, there is no change in our long-term bullish view. We expect the Nifty to retain its 22,000-26,500 sideways range. As such a bounce from around 22,500 or 22,000 can take the index higher towards 26,500, the upper end of the range in the medium term.

A bullish breakout above 26,500 will then bring into the picture the chances of the long-term rally to 28,000-30,000.

The bullish view will go wrong only if the Nifty declines



INDEX OUTLOOK. The benchmark indices have room to fall more

GETTYIMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

below 22,000.

NIFTY BANK (56,358.70)

Short-term view: Immediate resistance is at 56,600. A break above it can trigger a relief rise to 57,500 or even 57,800. A rise beyond 57,800 might not be easy. It will need some strong positive trigger.

A reversal either from 56,600 itself or from around 57,800 can drag the index down to 55,600, an important support. An eventual break below 55,600 can then take the Nifty Bank index down to 55,000 and lower.

Medium-term view: The break below 55,600 and the fall to 55,000 will be bearish to see 54,000-53,700 on the downside. Failure to get a sustained bounce thereafter will increase the danger of seeing 51,000-50,000 on the downside.

From a long-term perspective, 51,000-50,000 is a very strong support zone. As long as the Nifty Bank index stays above this support zone, the overall bullish view will remain intact. So, we retain our bullish view to see 65,000 and 68,000-69,000 on the upside in the long term. A strong rise above 60,000 will clear the way for this rally.

SENSEX (74,294.96)

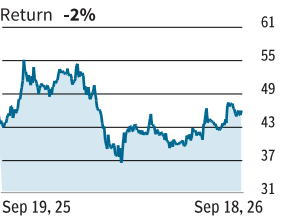
Short-term view: Key resistances are at 74,800 and 75,500. The downside remains open to see 73,400. A break below it can drag the Sensex down to 71,500.

A strong rise above 75,500 is needed to get some breather. Only then a rise to 76,000 and higher levels can be seen. We expect

MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

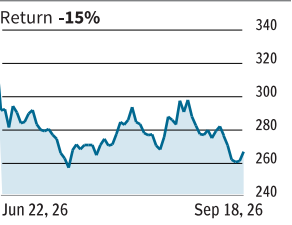
Sagility (₹45.63)
Steady uptrend



The stock of Sagility has been in an uptrend since March. Particularly since June, the scrip has been gradually appreciating, and the upswing has been happening within a rising channel. While the price has dropped recently, it remains above the lower end of the channel. Also, the price

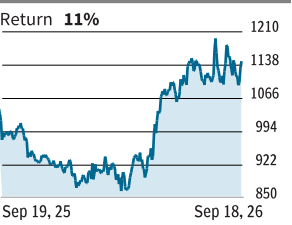
is above both 21- and 50-day moving averages, a bullish sign. The stock can continue to rise and over the medium-term, we expect it to reach ₹54. Therefore, participants can buy the stock now at ₹45.60 and ₹44. Place initial stop-loss at ₹41. When the price goes up to ₹49 and ₹52, revise the stop-loss higher to ₹46 and ₹50 respectively. Book profits at ₹54.

Vedanta (₹261.25)
Forms a strong base



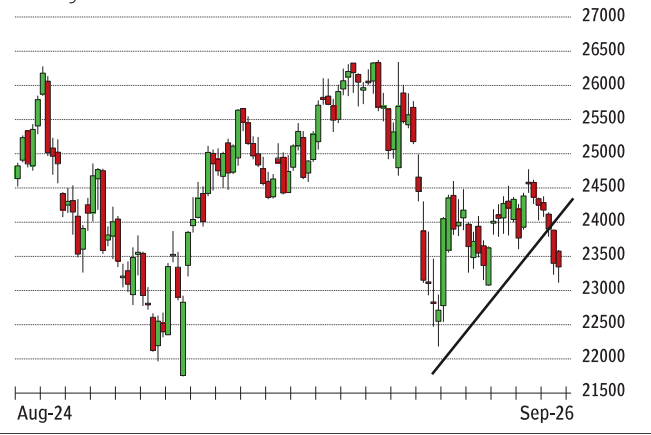
The trend has been bearish for the stock of Vedanta since May this year. That said, over the last two months, there has been a loss in downward momentum, and the scrip has largely been charting a sideways trend. The price action indicates a formation of a new base at ₹250. Notably, in the second half of last week, the stock rebounded from this support. Going ahead, we anticipate the uptrend to continue. In the medium-term, the price is likely to rally to ₹350. Hence, traders can buy now at ₹261 and accumulate at ₹252. Place stop-loss at ₹235. When the stock appreciates to ₹300 and ₹330, tighten the stop-loss to ₹275 and ₹315 respectively. Book profits at ₹350.

Zydus Lifesciences (₹1,153)
Set to breakout soon



The stock of Zydus Lifesciences has been witnessing a consolidation since early July. That is, it has been oscillating between ₹1,090 and ₹1,200. Nevertheless, the broader trend is bullish, and the chart shows that the stock has formed a solid base at ₹1,090. We expect the stock to gather enough momentum to surpass the resistance at ₹1,200. Once this occurs, it can rally to ₹1,350. Note that the stock could hit a pause at around ₹1,300 before this level is breached eventually. So, traders buy now at ₹1,153 and accumulate at ₹1,100. Keep stop-loss at ₹1,040. On a rally to ₹1,270 and ₹1,320, tighten the stop-loss to ₹1,190 and ₹1,290 respectively. Exit at ₹1,350.

Nifty 50: Downtrend intact



IMMEDIATE
RESISTANCE

- Nifty 50: 23,500
- Sensex: 74,800
- Nifty Bank: 56,600

pect the upside to be capped at 75,500 for now.

Medium-term view: The broader 71,000-86,000 range is intact. Within that, the Sensex is likely to go down towards the lower end of the range. We expect the Sensex to bounce back from the 71,500-71,000 region and go back up to 75,000 and 80,000 in the coming months.

Eventually, we expect a bullish breakout above 86,000 and a rise to 90,000 and 94,000 in the long term.

This bullish view will go wrong only if the Sensex breaks

below 71,000. That would need some strong negative trigger.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150
(22,901.85)

The fall to the 22,200-22,000 support zone happened as expected last week. The Nifty Midcap 150 index touched a low of 22,101 and then has risen back very well from there. If this bounce sustains and a strong follow-through rise happens from here, then 23,200-23,300 can be seen. It will also keep the upside open to see 23,800-24,000.

In case, the index falls back below 22,700 from here, then 22,500-22,000 can be seen again.

The long-term bullish view remains intact to see 26,000-26,500 and even 28,000 on the upside. A strong break above 24,000 will clear the way for this rally.



Yields
eye higher

US MARKET
OUTLOOK.
Rate hikes, elevated oil
price can aid the rise

GETTYIMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

● BULLISH OUTLOOK

The US 10Yr Treasury Yield can rise to 5.15 per cent.

and even 49,800 or 49,500 in the coming weeks.

S&P 500 (7,650.51)

The crucial support level of 7,500 has held very well last week. The S&P 500 index has risen back recovering almost all the loss from the low around 7,508.

A follow-through rise from here can take the index up to 7,700-7,720, a key short-term resistance. A decisive break above 7,720 will then clear the way for the rise to 7,800. It will also keep the upside open to see 8,000. But failure to breach 7,720 can drag the S&P 500 index down to 7,600-7,500 again. As mentioned last week, a strong break below 7,500 will only indicate a bearish trend reversal.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE
(26,522.55)

The break below 25,900 did not sustain. The index has risen back well from the low of 25,803. If the bounce sustains and the index manages to breach 26,700, then that will be positive. In that case, a rise to 27,300-27,350 can be seen. An extended rise to 28,500 is also a possibility.

From a big picture, the upside is likely to be capped either at 27,350 itself or around 28,500.

A strong downward reversal thereafter can drag the NASDAQ Composite index down towards 25,000. So, more caution is needed as the index goes up from here.

DOLLAR OUTLOOK

The dollar index (100.22) has made a bullish breakout above 99.85. The trigger for the break came after the US Federal Reserve's 25-basis points rate hike on Wednesday.

The region between 100 and 99.80 will now act as a good support zone. The outlook is bullish to see 101-101.30 from here. A decisive break above 101.30 is needed to boost the momentum and take the index higher to 102-103 levels.

The index will come under pressure only if it breaks below 99.80. If that happens, a fall to 99-98.80 can be seen.

TREASURY YIELD

The US 10Yr Treasury Yield (5 per cent) oscillated around 5 per cent all through the week. The Fed in its economic forecast has kept the doors open for another 25-bps rate hike for this year. This coupled with higher crude oil price can aid the yield to sustain higher.

There are good chances to see a rise to 5.15 per cent from here. Support is at 4.9 per cent. In case the yield breaks below it, then a fall to 4.8 per cent can happen first. Thereafter, a fresh rise can take it back above 5 per cent.

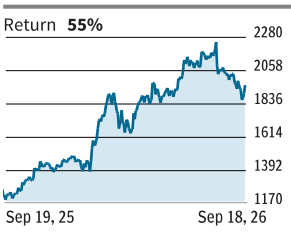
TECH QUERY



GURUMURTHY K, bl.research bureau

I have Bharat Forge shares. My average purchase price is ₹735. Can I continue to hold or book profit?

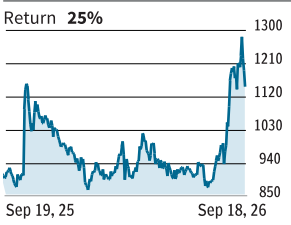
Parvathy, Kochi



Bharat Forge (₹1,976): The recent fall from the high of ₹2,293 is happening from around a strong long-term trendline resistance. This gives an early sign of top formation. Immediate resistance is around ₹2,000. Above that, the ₹2,050-₹2,080 region is the next strong resistance. A decisive rise above ₹2,080 is needed to turn the sentiment positive and go back up to ₹2,200-₹2,300 levels. But such a rise looks less likely. The bias is negative. There is room for a fall to ₹1,750-₹1,700 and even ₹1,620-₹1,600 in the next two-three months. So, it is better to exit the stock here and book profits. Whenever you enter any trade, identify major resistances and have a specific target. This will help to exit a trade before any major reversal happens.

I have bought Hatsun Agro Products at ₹1,067. What is the outlook? Can I continue to hold or exit?

Ramasubramanian

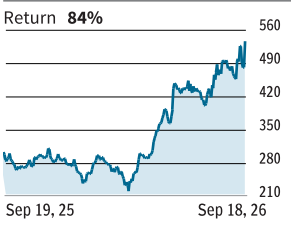


Hatsun Agro Products (₹1,139): The stock is stuck inside a wide range of ₹730 and ₹1,380 for more than four years. Within this, the price is coming down after touching a high of ₹1,350 earlier this month. This indicates that the broader

sideways range is still intact. Immediate support is at ₹1,135. A break below it can drag the price lower to ₹1,035 initially. It will also keep the downside open to see ₹900-₹800 levels. A sustained rise above ₹1,400 will confirm the bullish range breakout. Such a break will clear the way for a fresh rally to ₹2,000 in the long term. For now, you can exit the stock. You can consider re-entering this stock again once a bullish breakout above ₹1,400 happens.

What is the long-term outlook for NRB Bearings? I have bought this stock at ₹266. Should I exit?

Manoj Shah, Mumbai

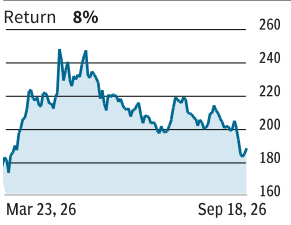


NRB Bearings (₹526): The stock has surged on Friday. It hit a new high of ₹535 and has closed higher. Support is at ₹450 which is holding very well. The outlook is bullish. There is potential to see ₹630-₹650 on the upside from here. Keep a

stop-loss at ₹430 and hold the stock. Move the stop-loss higher to ₹490 when the price goes up to ₹570. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹520 and ₹570 when the share price touches ₹590 and ₹605, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹630. The stock has been very volatile recently. So, if the price falls below ₹450, adhere to the stop-loss strictly and exit the stock. A subsequent fall below ₹420 will increase the danger of seeing ₹360 and lower levels.

I have Sandur Manganese & Iron Ores shares. My purchase price is ₹220. What is the outlook?

K S Venkatachalaapaathy, Erode



Sandur Manganese & Iron Ore (₹185): The stock seems to be struggling to get a sustained rise above ₹240. A crucial support is around ₹170. A break below it will indicate a bearish trend reversal. In that case, the share price

can fall to ₹145 initially. A further break below ₹145 can then see the price tumbling towards ₹115. To avoid this fall, the stock has to sustain above ₹170 and rise past ₹220. Only then it will get a breather. Also, a sustained rise above ₹240 is needed for the share price to go up towards ₹300 and higher. Since there is a danger of breaking below ₹170, it is better to exit the stock and accept the loss.

● Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

BANDU'S PICKS	These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week	Last week's prize winner J L Bheda
	1 Pine Labs	Last week's winning stock Jubilant Pharmova
	2 Prime Focus	Closing price (Sept 11) ₹1,025.10
	3 Action Construction Equipment	Closing price (Sept 18) ₹1,067.15
	4 Aegis Vopak Terminals	Return: 4.10 per cent
	5 City Union Bank	

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.



Scan to know the winner selection process

Takeaway 500

Valuation Card: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were down 0.7 and 0.2 per cent respectively last week. BSE Healthcare gained the most by 0.4 per cent, followed by BSE Oil & Gas and BSE FMCG at 0.2 per cent each. BSE Consumer Durables and BSE Realty declined by 3.3 and 1.1 per cent respectively last week.

	Nifty 50	Sensex	Auto	Bankex	Capital Goods	Consumer Durables	FMCG	Healthcare	IT	Metal	Oil & Gas	Power	PSU	Realty	Tech
P/E	19.7	19.7	35.3	13.6	50.6	60.3	31.7	44.8	18.9	17.3	11.4	31.2	11.1	38.2	19.5
P/BV	2.8	4.0	7.2	2.3	14.7	16.8	7.2	7.9	5.7	2.3	1.5	4.8	2.2	5.2	7.6
Dividend Yield	1.2	1.1	1.0	0.7	0.5	0.5	1.0	0.4	2.1	0.5	2.4	1.2	2.0	0.5	1.8
Weekly Return (%)	-0.2 ▼	-0.7 ▼	-0.3 ▼	-0.8 ▼	-0.9 ▼	-3.3 ▼	0.2 ▲	0.4 ▲	-0.8 ▼	0.0 ▼	0.2 ▲	-0.7 ▼	-0.9 ▼	-1.1 ▼	-0.1 ▼
Monthly Return (%)	-3.3 ▼	-3.8 ▼	-6.8 ▼	-2.1 ▼	-4.4 ▼	-7.1 ▼	-4.6 ▼	1.2 ▲	-5.1 ▼	-1.4 ▼	-2.2 ▼	-2.0 ▼	-3.6 ▼	-6.4 ▼	-4.4 ▼
Annual Return (%)	-8.2 ▼	-10.5 ▼	-1.4 ▼	1.4 ▲	8.0 ▲	-2.0 ▼	-17.4 ▼	14.0 ▲	-23.5 ▼	24.9 ▲	-3.7 ▼	9.8 ▲	1.9 ▲	-8.1 ▼	-16.7 ▼

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr-High	Yr-Low
360 ONE [1]	1082.8	30.9	35.0	4.8	202606	34.5	16.1	36.8	19.5	-0.9	12.1	1.6	1235.7	906.2
3M India [1]	34233.1	391.4	87.5	21.8	202606	19.0	-0.7	15.7	11.2	4.8	47.3	0.1	38300.0	28747.3
A														
A B B [2]	7235.2	72.7	99.5	16.4	202606	21.0	8.0	10.0	13.0	-0.5	9.8	0.1	7923.4	4640.5
A B Lifestyle [1]	81.1	17	46.3	7.0	202606	11.1	20.6	9.1	31.5	-2.8	12.5	0.2	150.8	80.8
A B Real Estate [1]	1271.3	-29.2	3.8	3.8	202606	30.4	-255.2	-55.2	-267.7	-1.0	-4.1	1.4	1962.3	1084.0
Aadhar Hsg. Fin. [1]	461.8	26.3	17.6	2.7	202606	17.1	19.0	17.7	21.5	1.2	13.3	0.8	563.0	425.1
Aarti Industries [1]	490.5	14.4	34.1	3.0	202606	42.5	256.5	27.0	122.2	-0.3	6.9	0.5	551.5	338.2
Aavas Financiers [1]	1281.2	61.9	20.7	2.7	202403	21.4	12.3	25.4	14.2	0.5	9.9	3.2	1775.0	1050.3
Adani Indus [1]	123.9	13.9	8.9	1.2	202606	4.3	17.1	6.3	11.2	6.6	4.8	0.0	3232.9	271.3
Adani Indus [1]	1265.3	101.2	12.5	1.2	202606	4.6	-56.3	11.5	18.6	1.5	11.2	0.0	1986.9	126.0
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	434.4	8.4	51.6	3.9	202606	67.8	64.8	47.5	45.4	8.1	7.4	2.8	405.5	195.7
Action Const.Eq. [2]	1229.3	36.7	33.5	7.3	202606	20.5	22.3	5.2	3.3	8.8	31.6	0.0	1241.5	746.1
Acucias Chemical [1]	2386.0	98.8	27.2	17.0	202606	59.1	67.7	40.9	105.3	1.8	32.2	0.0	3735.0	1250.0
Adani Energy [1]	115.0	23.9	5.3	6.0	202606	42.4	124.2	20.0	21.8	0.0	9.5	19	1789.0	894.7
Adani Entersol. [1]	2999.1	19.0	157.7	4.3	202606	49.9	14.9	18.1	-28.8	-1.9	5.6	1.5	3245.0	1753.5
Adani Green [1]	1313.7	11.9	109.9	11.2	202606	15.6	16.6	7.2	1.0	2.5	8.0	0.7	1631.4	708.0
Adani Ports [2]	100.0	57.7	31.2	4.3	202606	18.6	9.2	23.8	16.8	2.0	13.7	0.1	1891.9	1293.1
Adani Power [2]	295.0	16.1	17.7	2.8	202606	30.4	42.0	6.6	14.9	-0.4	16.6	0.8	254.2	125.2
Adani Total Gas [1]	660.7	5.7	114.9	14.9	202606	27.2	-14.2	19.8	-2.4	11.1	14.8	0.5	859.7	453.5
Aditya AVM [1]	1061.2	34.9	30.4	7.6	202606	3.5	11.7	6.6	3.9	-3.5	32.2	0.0	1224.4	708.0
Aditya Bkr. Fas. [1]	150.2	-6.1	1.1	202606	10.6	-201.5	11.4	-1.4	-0.6	0.0	0.9	95.0	48.8	
Aditya Birla Cap. [1]	400.1	46.7	27.2	2.9	202606	28.2	40.1	16.3	18.2	4.7	16.1	0.8	430.6	278.1
Aditya Birla Infotech [1]	3351.9	40.3	83.1	21.1	202606	89.5	-325.5	51.8	214.8	-12.5	28.1	0.3	4094.5	1228.9
Aegis Logistics [1]	1417.3	35.6	39.8	8.2	202606	37.1	268.9	30.4	88.7	4.7	16.8	0.8	1498.0	576.0
Aegis Vopak Term. [1]	3152.0	24	129.0	10.2	202606	12.4	-7.0	26.1	42.9	6.9	8.7	1.9	371.0	158.8
Aethon Industri. [1]	1220.0	44.3	90.1	8.8	202606	27.2	28.0	34.4	30.4	-2.6	16.6	0.1	2706.3	723.4
Afcans Infrastr. [2]	263.4	5.6	47.3	1.8	202606	-20.8	-77.7	-11.9	-61.5	3.7	10.5	0.6	479.1	225.6
Affle 31 [2]	1600.6	33.9	47.2	6.1	202606	20.4	-21.7	19.8	19.2	3.1	16.7	0.0	2186.8	1251.9
Alfa Engineering [2]	329.7	136.0	29.2	4.6	202606	12.4	-1.3	5.5	14.7	-3.0	21.1	0.1	517.0	302.9
Alkerm Pharma [2]	4380.0	98.8	44.3	90.1	202606	21.2	28.0	34.4	30.4	-2.6	16.6	0.1	2706.3	723.4
Alkem Lab [2]	5501.6	190.6	28.9	4.8	202606	20.9	-20.5	13.4	0.2	8.1	19.7	0.1	5933.0	5052.1
Allied Blenders [2]	651.0	8.0	81.6	11.0	202606	6.1	-13.0	8.0	-7.1	3.0	18.3	0.6	129.0	382.7
Alok Industries [1]	7.1	-1.5	-0.2	202606	6.5	-178.8	3.9	18.6	-4.3	0.0	0.0	19.3	7.0	
Amara Raja Ener. [1]	795.5	39.9	19.9	1.8	202606	23.9	15.9	12.7	-6.9	-2.3	11.7	0.1	1039.5	671.5
Amara Raja Ener. [1]	7129.0	56.1	127.1	20.8	202606	12.7	-3.4	14.6	-28.1	-1.5	10.6	0.7	8970.0	5404.0
Amul Cement [2]	39.2	19.2	20.5	1.6	202606	-0.7	-29.1	7.1	-5.7	0.4	6.7	0.0	600.8	379.6
Anand Rathil Wea. [1]	2230.8	28.0	79.7	37.1	202606	17.5	73.8	22.7	45.2	0.9	59.8	0.1	267.0	1354.0
Anant Raj [2]	696.3	16.1	37.7	3.8	202606	6.6	19.9	17.0	25.7	1.2	12.0	0.1	744.1	463.0
Anant Raj [2]	300.0	11.3	26.6	4.5	202606	25.4	102.1	9.1	3.8	-1.6	14.8	1.0	360.2	208.9
Anthem Bioscienc [2]	933.8	10.5	88.7	17.3	202606	-22.6	-11.7	-2.1	17.6	-0.9	29.3	0.0	977.0	579.5
Apur Inds. [1]	18873.9	287.9	65.6	10.0	202606	29.2	77.8	24.0	36.7	7.9	31.1	0.2	19054.0	6800.0
Asi Apollo Tubes [2]	2001.7	42.4	46.9	11.2	202606	8.7	10.9	10.5	23.4	-1.2	12.0	0.1	744.1	463.0
Apollo Hospitals [2]	4770.3	146.3	19.9	13.3	202606	20.6	34.2	17.2	33.7	-0.9	18.1	0.7	9326.8	6680.0
Apollo Tyres [1]	411.8	33.6	12.3	1.6	202606	12.8	0.1	11.2	72.5	-1.4	33.4	0.3	540.3	365.4
Apus Value Hou. [2]	237.7	19.7	12.1	2.4	202606	15.4	19.0	23.1	33.3	-4.7	15.4	1.6	334.2	193.5
Aptiv India Gias [1]	961.6	17.5	54.9	6.2	202606	10.2	195.5	11.3	27.0	-2.4	11.2	0.7	1073.0	775.1
Ashok Leyland [1]	145.0	3.2	45.6	20.2	202606	11.1	0.8	16.4	17.2	4.3	21.8	1.3	215.4	134.2
Asian Paints [1]	2405.0	59.9	47.3	10.8	202606	17.9	40.0	9.9	26.7	-2.6	25.9	0.2	2985.5	2116.0
Aster DM Quality [1]	755.9	45	169.8	15.7	202606	21.6	-17.0	15.7	8.6	-0.9	11.8	0.6	891.0	519.8
Astral [1]	1425.0	22.1	64.6	9.4	202606	15.9	48.2	16.8	22.3	1.1	19.4	0.1	1768.0	1331.0
Aster Indus [1]	1610.0	-9.7	15.7	202606	88.8	-124.5	67.2	52.4	-2.7	0.0	0.4	0.4	1741.9	539.8
Atul [1]	619.0	27.2	22.9	2.9	202606	25.0	92.0	15.8	59.1	-0.9	14.9	0.9	719.8	5563.0
Atul Small Finance [1]	1041.0	38.1	27.4	4.0	202606	21.1	37.0	17.3	30.8	-1.6	0.0	0.0	1447.4	703.9
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	1735.0	65.7	26.4	2.6	202606	16.9	28.1	9.4	11.5	3.6	12.4	0.2	1735.0	1066.0
Authum Invest [1]	559.5	24.7	22.6	3.2	202606	20.9	17.8	-34.6	-48.7	2.4	13.6	0.2	683.5	400.0
Avenue Super. [2]	3738.0	46.9	79.7	10.0	202606	14.9	11.3	15.6	13.0	1.4	17.2	0.1	4815.9	3528.7
AWG Agr Busine. [1]	187.0	9.0	20.7	2.3	202606	17.5	48.2	16.7	-2.3	1.0	17.1	0.2	282.9	117.2
Axis Bank [2]	1240.9	89.2	13.9	1.7	202606	9.9	22.2	5.6	-0.3	-0.5	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1121.0
B														
BHEL [2]	434.0	7.0	62.1	5.8	202606	40.3	-17.3	27.0	739.4	0.8	5.6	0.3	446.8	220.1
Bajaj Auto [1]	307.1	35.7	8.6	11.7	202606	34.4	15.5	12.3	7.1	0.8	21.9	2.0	391.7	265.6
Bajaj Auto [1]	11499.9	428.9	26.8	8.1	202606	65.0	45.9	36.3	55.2	-0.6	28.4	0.4	12470.0	8490.1
Bajaj Finance [1]	1027.0	32.9	31.2	5.6	202606	19.6	27.4	18.8	17.6	-0.7	10.9	3.8	1177.6	788.4
Bajaj Finserv [1]	449.9	48.9	28.5	3.8	202606	19.4	12.3	14.9	9.3	-3.5	11.8	5.2	2194.7	1598.2
Bajaj Holdings [1]	1181.9	79.5	14.2	1.7	202606	16.4	12.3	16.3	19.3	-1.2	10.1	0.6	1247.0	849.0
Bajaj Housing [1]	128.5	3.2	36.4	1.2	202606	17.1	22.6	16.3	12.6	1.6	8.8	1.4	11.1	72.6
Balkrishna Inds [2]	226.7	7.2	31.2	4.0	202606	25.2	56.4	9.8	-3.3	4.7	10.9	0.4	2775.0	197.0
Balarampuri Chini [1]	67.2	17.5	38.3	3.1	202606	6.1	14.4	15.0	-11.3	-2.9	9.3	0.7	781.0	393.4
Bata India [1]	40.8	20.8	1.9	0.2	202606	13.2	-40.2	34.1	1.0	-0.2	34.1	0.0	20.8	1.0
Bata India [1]	40.8	20.8	1.9	0.2	202606	13.2	-40.2	34.1	1.0	-0.2	34.1	0.0	20.8	1.0
Bank of Baroda [2]	234.8	42.9	5.5	0.7	202606	8.8	68.2	4.9	14.1	-1.3	0.0	0.0	323.5	232.1
Bank of India [1]	140.1	25.9	5.4	0.8	202606	8.8	49.8	6.2	19.4	0.2	0.0	0.0	178.5	116.0
Bank of Maha. [1]	82.0	9.8	8.4	1.9	202606	13.9	34.5	15.8	31.0	-2.6	0.0	0.0	94.5	53.8
Bata India [1]	40.8	20.8	1.9	0.2	202606	13.2	-40.2	34.1	1.0	-0.2	34.1	0.0	20.8	1.0
Bata India [1]	40.8	20.8	1.9	0.2	202606	13.2	-40.2	34.1	1.0	-0.2	34.1	0.0	20.8	1.0
Bayer Crop Sci. [1]	3786.6	162.9	23.2	5.0	202606	40.2	15.9	12.8	23.6	-4.9	12.0	0.0	5407.9	3763.3
BEML India [5]	240.5	5.3	45.6	3.4	202606	12.6	8.9	11.6	29.1	5.5	14.1	1.1	268.0	142.0
BERL Indus [1]	2134.3	21.4	99.6	6.1	202606	29.3	-142.1							



bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS

*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	105.3	80206	1.1	0.7	-6.5	9.3	10.2	12.5	0.35
*****	Invesco India Largecap	71.3	2021	1.8	0.7	0.0	11.9	9.8	11.9	0.30
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	87.4	54134	1.2	0.6	-6.6	9.3	11.9	13.0	0.40
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	217.7	2641	1.7	0.7	-2.3	9.7	9.1	11.7	0.28
*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	60.3	17092	1.4	0.5	-6.1	8.3	7.4	12.2	0.22
*****	JM Large Cap	151.4	394	2.1	0.8	-3.3	8.6	9.2	10.3	0.28
*****	SBI Large Cap	91.2	55140	1.2	0.7	-3.3	7.7	8.2	10.9	0.26
***	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	506.3	29711	1.4	0.8	-5.8	8.0	8.1	10.7	0.25
***	Bandhan Large Cap	76.9	2180	1.7	0.8	-2.4	10.8	8.9	11.6	0.27
***	DSP Large Cap	443.9	7101	1.5	0.8	-7.5	8.8	7.9	9.7	0.24
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	81.7	1434	1.8	0.6	-4.2	7.9	8.0	11.5	0.24
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	993.4	7490	1.5	0.9	-5.3	8.2	6.9	9.8	0.21
***	HDFC Large Cap	1104.5	39933	1.3	0.8	-4.5	7.7	10.1	11.6	0.33
***	HSBC Large Cap	468.2	1855	1.8	1.0	-3.0	8.3	7.9	11.0	0.22
***	Kotak Large Cap	551.1	10937	1.5	0.6	-5.6	8.2	7.7	11.3	0.23
***	Mahi Manu Large Cap	21.5	695	2.0	0.7	-7.8	6.1	6.6	-	0.19
***	Tata Large Cap	496.2	2765	1.7	0.8	-3.3	8.6	8.3	10.8	0.25
***	Groww Largecap	42.1	137	2.1	0.9	-4.2	8.5	7.7	9.8	0.21
***	Mirae Asset Large Cap	109.5	38166	1.3	0.5	-5.1	6.8	6.6	11.5	0.19
**	Union Largecap	22.6	437	2.1	1.3	-5.8	6.1	6.3	-	0.17
**	UTI Large Cap	259.9	12189	1.5	0.8	-7.1	5.9	5.7	10.4	0.15
**	Axis Large Cap	59.0	31376	1.3	0.6	-4.9	7.5	4.6	11.1	0.09
**	LIC MF Large Cap	52.8	1385	1.8	0.9	-7.2	6.2	5.0	9.2	0.12
**	PGIM India Large Cap	323.8	538	2.1	0.8	-7.1	5.2	4.9	9.0	0.12
-	Taurus Large Cap	167.3	60	2.1	1.9	4.9	12.0	9.9	9.8	0.29

EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	140.4	21020	1.4	0.4	2.3	16.2	15.5	14.6	0.48
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	1025.0	33592	1.3	0.7	-0.5	13.9	14.8	14.3	0.54
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	124.3	3487	1.7	0.6	8.4	13.4	14.3	14.8	0.41
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	34.8	17320	1.4	0.5	3.9	14.0	10.8	-	0.31
*****	HDFC Large & Mid Cap	343.1	30294	1.4	0.8	-1.2	11.6	13.5	14.0	0.43
*****	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	109.4	12387	1.5	0.5	5.3	21.0	15.7	15.7	0.44
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	182.5	6514	1.6	0.8	0.5	13.3	13.0	13.2	0.43
***	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	92.3	529	2.1	0.9	4.4	12.0	10.6	12.2	0.31
***	DSP Large & Mid Cap	607.8	18411	1.4	0.5	-2.7	11.9	10.6	13.2	0.33
***	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	89.7	4942	1.6	0.5	1.9	12.6	11.5	13.8	0.35
***	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	30.1	5931	1.6	0.7	8.1	16.8	13.3	-	0.34
***	Kotak Large & Mid Cap	346.7	32325	1.3	0.5	-0.4	11.9	12.0	14.0	0.36
***	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	155.2	45811	1.3	0.5	0.8	10.6	9.6	15.4	0.29
***	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1474.7	7903	1.5	0.9	-2.1	13.4	12.3	12.2	0.39
***	SBI Large & Midcap	635.0	42336	1.3	0.6	0.1	11.1	12.5	13.6	0.41
**	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	255.2	26331	1.4	0.5	-4.0	11.3	9.3	13.9	0.28
**	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	188.7	3622	1.6	1.1	-3.7	10.3	9.2	10.9	0.28
**	LIC MF Large & Midcap	38.8	3198	1.7	0.5	-1.1	12.3	9.9	13.1	0.30
**	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	93.0	7544	1.5	0.7	7.0	13.3	10.9	14.1	0.33
**	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	954.3	5998	1.6	0.9	3.9	10.5	6.8	10.5	0.17
*	Navi Large & Midcap	36.2	315	2.1	0.5	1.3	7.8	8.7	11.6	0.26
*	Tata Large & Mid Cap	491.9	7679	1.5	0.6	-6.6	5.9	8.2	11.4	0.23

EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS

*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	2036.0	113606	1.1	0.6	-0.8	14.2	16.1	15.0	0.59
*****	JM Flexi Cap	99.6	5291	1.6	0.5	-0.7	13.2	14.1	15.1	0.42
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	81.9	147405	1.1	0.5	-5.7	11.3	10.4	16.1	0.39
*****	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1931.2	29044	1.4	0.7	5.5	13.3	10.5	12.9	0.33
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	38.3	3722	1.6	0.5	-1.3	12.2	10.9	13.6	0.33
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1569.4	19385	1.4	0.8	-5.2	9.6	10.9	12.4	0.34
*****	HSBC Flexi Cap	232.8	6000	1.6	0.9	4.0	14.4	12.2	12.4	0.34
***	Axis Flexi Cap	28.4	13943	1.5	0.6	3.1	12.7	7.8	-	0.20
***	Bandhan Flexi Cap	206.0	7508	1.5	1.0	-3.4	9.5	8.7	10.3	0.26
***	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	337.7	13679	1.5	0.5	-3.7	9.9	8.1	13.1	0.24
***	DSP Flexi Cap	102.0	12500	1.5	0.6	-2.5	9.7	8.4	12.7	0.23
***	Kotak Flexi Cap	83.3	56392	1.2	0.5	-3.4	9.9	9.3	12.1	0.28
***	Navi Flexi Cap	24.8	297	2.1	0.5	7.2	9.0	9.4	-	0.28
***	PGIM India Flexi Cap	36.8	5963	1.6	0.5	-1.6	8.8	6.8	12.7	0.17
***	Union Flexi Cap	52.0	2452	1.7	0.8	-0.3	9.7	9.0	12.2	0.26
**	LIC MF Flexi Cap	105.8	1125	1.9	0.9	3.1	10.4	9.4	10.1	0.27
**	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	63.2	14160	1.4	0.7	-1.7	16.7	11.8	12.1	0.32
**	SBI Flexicap	107.5	23235	1.4	0.7	-2.9	7.1	7.1	11.0	0.20
**	Tata Flexi Cap	23.1	3663	1.6	0.6	-7.4	8.2	7.2	-	0.21
*	Shriram Flexi Cap	19.4	131	2.1	0.8	-4.5	5.6	5.6	-	0.13
*	Taurus Flexi Cap	241.6	382	2.1	2.0	5.5	10.7	10.0	9.7	0.29
*	UTI Flexi Cap	321.4	24163	1.4	0.8	-4.1	7.1	3.8	11.2	0.08
-	Quant Flexi Cap	108.2	7364	1.5	0.6	10.8	14.3	13.6	18.2	0.37

EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS

-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	292.9	3493	1.7	0.8	0.4	13.2	11.7	13.3	0.34
-	ICICI Pru Multi Cap	850.2	19538	1.4	0.8	5.4	14.6	13.8	13.6	0.46
-	Invesco India Multicap	131.7	4529	1.6	0.6	-0.7	12.0	10.5	13.0	0.29
-	ITI Multicap	26.1	1543	1.8	0.5	9.3	15.1	12.3	-	0.35
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	39.6	7662	1.5	0.4	10.3	15.7	14.3	-	0.41
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	298.2	56298	1.2	0.6	-3.0	12.0	15.8	14.6	0.51
-	Quant Multi Cap	661.1	7725	1.5	0.6	5.1	8.7	10.5	16.8	0.27
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	392.3	3070	1.7	0.8	0.4	11.8	11.1	13.6	0.33

EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	108.2	19891	1.4	0.4	5.2	19.4	16.9	17.5	0.49
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4476.1	52271	1.2	0.6	5.6	17.2	17.0	17.4	0.52
*****	Quant Mid Cap	218.2	8056	1.5	0.7	2.5	9.7	14.2	16.8	0.40
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	208.7	108325	1.1	0.6	5.4	16.5	18.1	16.5	0.59
*****	Invesco India Midcap	197.1	15905	1.4	0.5	6.8	21.9	18.2	18.0	0.50
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	36.1	5406	1.6	0.5	7.5	16.3	16.2	-	0.48
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	103.8	42852	1.3	0.6	-2.8	17.7	20.0	16.2	0.54
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	111.4	2658	1.7	0.5	8.7	15.4	13.8	14.7	0.41
***	HSBC Midcap	473.8	17188	1.4	0.5	17.4	22.9	17.8	16.6	0.47
***	ICICI Pru Mid Cap	342.5	8403	1.5	0.9	12.6	20.5	16.7	16.0	0.51
***	Kotak Mid Cap	144.9	71256	1.2	0.3	3.6	16.5	15.3	16.6	0.46
***	PGIM India Midcap	66.8	11218	1.5	0.5	-1.7	10.1	9.3	14.6	0.27
***	SBI Midcap	238.5	24518	1.4	0.7	2.3	9.6	12.6	13.0	0.39
***	Sundaram Mid Cap	1480.9	14863	1.4	0.8	4.4	17.1	15.7	13.8	0.48
**	Tata Mid Cap	460.7	6240	1.6	0.5	4.8	14.0	13.6	15.4	0.41
**	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	845.5	6966	1.6	0.9	5.4	14.0	13.0	12.8	0.39
**	Axis Midcap	122.0	35425	1.3	0.5	5.1	15.4	11.8	16.5	0.35
**	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2800.3	13052	1.5	0.8	0.3	14.7	12.8	13.6	0.37
**	UTI Mid Cap	314.3	12795	1.5	0.7	2.1	10.9	10.8	13.2	0.32
**	DSP Midcap	154.3	21019	1.4	0.6	2.4	13.1	10.6	13.3	0.31
**	LIC MF Midcap	30.9	392	2.1	1.2	4.0	15.1	11.8	-	0.33
*	Taurus Mid Cap	128.5	140	2.1	1.7	3.1	9.4	11.8	14.1	0.33

EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS

*****	Bank of India Small Cap	58.2	3307	1.7	0.4	23.3	20.1	18.2	-	0.46
*****	Quant Small Cap	292.3	35557	1.3	0.6	12.7	16.8	18.4	19.9	0.45
*****	Edelweiss Small Cap	47.8	7253	1.5	0.4	6.9	14.2	15.5	-	0.44
*****	Invesco India Smallcap	48.2	15744	1.4	0.4	12.8	21.6	18.5	-	0.48

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

★★★★	Nippon Ind Small Cap	185.2	82580	1.1	0.5	7.5	14.5	17.9	20.0	0.48
★★★★	Union Small Cap	60.7	2667	1.7	0.8	19.9	16.7	16.5	16.4	0.42
★★★★	AXIS Small Cap	117.7	31448	1.4	0.6	8.6	14.7	14.9	18.1	0.45
★★★	Canara Robeco Small Cap	41.1	14661	1.5	0.5	4.1	11.6	13.6	-	0.38
★★★	DSP Small Cap	232.3	21659	1.4	0.7	16.2	16.8	17.3	16.3	0.46
★★★	HSBC Small Cap	92.1	19076	1.4	0.6	11.0	14.0	16.7	17.8	0.41
★★★	Kotak Small Cap	276.5	19679	1.4	0.5	4.6	11.5	11.7	16.0	0.32
★★★	LIC MF Small Cap	35.6	832	2.0	0.8	13.3	17.7	16.9	-	0.43
★★★	Sundaram Small Cap	299.8	4155	1.6	0.7	13.5	16.1	15.9	14.3	0.42
★★	Franklin Ind Small Cap	178.6	14746	1.5	0.8	3.7	12.2	15.0	14.2	0.40
★★	HDFC Small Cap	140.1	41891	1.3	0.6	-3.4	10.0	13.8	16.5	0.38
★★	ICICI Pru Small Cap	91.1	9821	1.5	0.7	1.2	10.3	13.3	14.9	0.41
★★	Tata Small Cap	39.8	13094	1.5	0.4	-2.2	11.2	13.9	-	0.35
★	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	100.7	6226	1.6	0.8	16.2	14.5	12.9	12.6	0.34
★	SBI Small Cap	185.9	42631	1.3	0.6	5.7	11.1	13.4	17.8	0.40

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Month %ann	3 Month %ann	6 Month %ann	1 Year CAGR	

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid	2159.7	629	0.3	0.2	6.1	6.1	6.5	6.2	-
- Aditya Birla SL Liquid	453.3	69830	0.3	0.2	6.1	6.4	6.8	6.4	-
- Axis Liquid	3134.2	63343	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.4	6.9	6.5	-
- Bandhan Liquid	3394.3	20198	0.2	0.1	6.0	6.2	6.7	6.3	-
- Bank of India Liquid	3241.6	1825	0.1	0.1	6.4	6.5	6.8	6.5	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3231.8	13194	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.3	6.7	6.4	0.60
- Canara Robeco Liquid	3385.1	6783	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.3	6.8	6.4	-
- DSP Liquid	4017.1	27920	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.4	6.8	6.4	0.60
- Edelweiss Liquid	3599.1	13272	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.4	6.9	6.5	-
- Groww Liquid	2720.1	381	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.3	6.7	6.4	-
- HDFC Liquid	5517.7	71323	0.3	0.2	6.2	6.3	6.8	6.4	-
- HSBC Liquid	2803.8	20975	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.3	6.8	6.4	-
- ICICI Pru Liquid	416.2	62798	0.3	0.2	6.1	6.3	6.8	6.4	-
- Invesco India Liquid	3867.1	20748	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.4	6.9	6.4	-
- ITI Liquid	1460.3	52	0.2	0.1	5.5	5.9	6.3	6.0	-
- JM Liquid	76.7	1743	0.2	0.1	6.0	6.3	6.6	6.3	-
- Kotak Liquid	5682.8	49073	0.3	0.1	6.1	6.3	6.8	6.4	-
- LIC MF Liquid	5083.3	17484	0.2	0.1	6.0	6.3	6.8	6.4	-
- Mahi Manu Liquid	1830.6	1392	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.5	6.8	6.4	-
- Mirae Asset Liquid	2947.1	17359	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.3	6.7	6.3	-
- Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.8	1015	0.4	0.2	5.5	5.8	6.1	5.9	-
- Navi Liquid	30.4	74	0.3	0.2	5.0	5.5	5.8	5.7	-
- Nippon Ind Liquid	6863.9	43125	0.3	0.2	6.1	6.3	6.8	6.4	-
- Parag Parikh Liquid	1559.1	6722	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.3	6.7	6.3	-
- PGIM India Liquid	366.2	1031	0.2	0.1	6.0	6.3	6.8	6.4	-
- Quant Liquid	44.2	1426	0.5	0.3	5.8	5.8	5.9	5.8	-
- Quantum Liquid	37.5	556	0.2	0.1	5.7	5.9	6.0	5.8	-
- SBI Liquid	4394.8	92192	0.3	0.2	6.0	6.3	6.8	6.4	-
- Sundaram Liquid	2479.2	9094	0.3	0.1	5.9	6.5	6.8	6.4	-
- Tata Liquid	4429.1	32370	0.3	0.2	6.1	6.3	6.7	6.4	-
- TRUSTMF Liquid	1365.1	1203	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.3	6.7	6.3	-
- Union Liquid	2706.4	7578	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.3	6.8	6.4	-
- UTI Liquid	461.5	29218	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.3	6.8	6.4	-
- WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1511.1	743	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.3	6.7	6.3	-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1478.2	10464	0.2	0.1	4.7	4.9	5.0	5.2	-
- Axis Overnight	1454.4	11325	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.1	5.2	5.3	-
- Bandhan Overnight	1458.8	1160	0.1	0.0	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Bank of India Overnight	1399.0	109	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.5	5.5	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1441.8	852	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Canara Robeco Overnight	1421.9	737	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- DSP Overnight	1468.3	2854	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Edelweiss Overnight	1421.1	192	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Franklin Ind Overnight	1433.8	685	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.1	5.2	5.3	-
- Groww Overnight	1410.6	12	0.2	0.1	4.6	4.8	4.9	5.1	-
- HDFC Overnight	4044.2	12190	0.2	0.1	4.7	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
- HSBC Overnight	1430.7	4535	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- ICICI Pru Overnight	1476.6	14368	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Invesco India Overnight	1388.3	343	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- ITI Overnight	1384.6	14	0.2	0.1	4.4	4.7	4.8	4.9	-
- JM Overnight	1390.0	148	0.1	0.1	4.6	4.8	4.9	5.0	-
- Kotak Overnight	1461.2	8618	0.2	0.1	4.7	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- LIC MF Overnight	1417.6	732	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Mahi Manu Overnight	1417.0	77	0.1	0.1	4.7	4.9	5.0	5.2	-
- Mirae Asset Overnight	1405.6	1727	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Nippon Ind Overnight	147.1	8548	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- PGIM India Overnight	1414.7	153	0.1	0.1	4.7	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
- SBI Overnight	4422.8	23407	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Sundaram Overnight	1454.0	1335	0.1	0.1	4.7	5.0	5.0	5.1	-
- Tata Overnight	1443.8	4571	0.2	0.1	4.7	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Union Overnight	1441.1	411	0.2	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- UTI Overnight	3732.3	5648	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	28.5	27237	0.9	0.3	7.1	6.5	5.8	6.2	-
- Axis Arbitrage	20.1	10594	0.9	0.3	6.8	6.3	5.8	6.1	-
- Bandhan Arbitrage	34.7	7796	0.9	0.3	6.5	6.2	5.6	5.9	-
- Bank of India Arbitrage	14.7	134	0.9	0.4	7.0	6.2	5.3	5.7	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	17.2	1055	1.0	0.3	6.2	5.8	5.3	5.7	-
- DSP Arbitrage	16.0	6673	0.8	0.3	5.6	5.9	5.5	5.9	-
- Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.8	14849	0.9	0.3	6.7	6.4	5.8	6.1	-
- HDFC Arbitrage	32.9	25509	0.8	0.3	7.0	6.4	5.9	6.2	-
- HSBC Arbitrage	20.3	3288	0.8	0.2	5.0	5.8	5.5	6.0	-
- ICICI Pru Arbitrage	36.8	34850	0.8	0.3	7.1	6.6	5.9	6.2	-
- Invesco India Arbitrage	34.3	30618	0.9	0.3	6.5	6.4	5.9	6.2	-
- ITI Arbitrage	13.9	63	0.8	0.2	6.5	7.1	5.8	6.3	-
- JM Arbitrage	34.8	482	0.9	0.4	5.0	5.4	5.1	5.6	-
- Kotak Arbitrage	40.2	75712	0.8	0.3	6.9	6.5	6.0	6.2	-
- LIC MF Arbitrage	14.8	310	0.7	0.2	6.9	6.4	5.9	6.1	-
- Mahi Manu Arbitrage	13.2	134	1.0	0.3	7.0	6.1	5.3	5.7	-
- Mirae Asset Arbitrage	14.0	3838	0.8	0.1	7.9	6.6	5.8	6.1	-
- Nippon Ind Arbitrage	28.5	17533	0.9	0.3	6.8	6.3	5.8	6.1	-
- PGIM India Arbitrage	19.6	99	0.9	0.3	5.2	5.9	5.6	5.9	-
- SBI Arbitrage	36.3	47283	0.8	0.3	6.7	6.3	5.8	6.2	-
- Sundaram Arbitrage	15.5	554	0.8	0.2	6.4	6.2	5.9	6.2	-
- Tata Arbitrage	15.4	24950	0.9	0.3	5.8	6.0	5.6	6.0	-
- Union Arbitrage	15.0	221	0.9	0.3	6.6	6.6	6.0	6.1	-
- UTI Arbitrage	37.6	11132	0.8	0.3	6.3	6.0	5.7	6.1	-

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT TERM FUNDS

***** Aditya Birla SL Ultra Short Term	592.1	18819	0.5	0.3	6.4	7.2	7.2	6.5	9.15
***** Baroda BNP Pari Ultra Short Term	1664.5	666	0.4	0.2	6.4	6.9	7.1	6.5	-
***** Mirae Asset Ultra Short-Term	1412.1	2066	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.0	7.2	6.4	11.75
***** Bandhan Ultra Short Term	16.4	4180	0.4	0.2	6.3	6.8	7.0	6.3	-
***** HSBC Ultra Short Term	1460.7	3628	0.3	0.1	6.5	6.9	7.0	6.3	-
***** ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.9	15974	0.7	0.3	6.3	6.9	7.0	6.3	8.04
***** Nippon Ind Ultra Short Term	4335.9	12447	0.9	0.3	6.2	6.7	6.8	6.2	19.81
*** Axis Ultra Short Term	15.8	6074	1.1	0.3	5.9	6.4	6.6	5.9	10.15
*** DSP Ultra Short Term	3654.6	4599	0.9	0.3	6.0	6.5	6.7	5.9	6.54
*** HDFC Ultra Short Term	16.3	17465	0.6	0.3	6.1	6.7	6.9	6.2	9.03
*** Invesco India Ultra Short Term	2902.4	1497	0.7	0.2	6.2	6.7	6.9	6.1	4.68
*** Kotak Ultra Short Term	46.1	15962	0.7	0.3	6.1	6.6	6.7	6.1	7.15
*** Mahi Manu Ultra Short Term	1480.9	222	0.6	0.3	6.2	6.7	6.9	6.1	2.03
*** SBI Ultra Short Term	6435.5	11880	0.5	0.3	6.3	6.8	6.9	6.2	10.96
*** Tata Ultra Short Term	15.2	6495	1.0	0.3	6.1	6.5	6.6	5.9	9.97
*** UTI Ultra Short Term	4551.8	3348	0.9	0.3	6.0	6.5	6.7	6.6	11.61
*** WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Term	1459.3	584	0.7	0.2	5.9	6.3	6.4	5.7	-
*** BOI Ultra Short Duration	3392.6	184	0.9	0.4	6.0	6.4	6.4	5.8	-
*** Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	4074.3	582	0.8	0.3	5.9	6.4	6.5	5.7	-
*** LIC MF Ultra Short Term	1415.6	678	1.2	0.2	5.8	6.3	6.4	5.7	2.26
*** PGIM India Ultra Short Term	36.5	211	0.8	0.3	5.6	6.2	6.4	5.8	-
*** ITI Ultra Short Term	1322.4	165	0.8	0.2	5.7	6.1	6.3	5.5	-
*** Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.5	524	1.0	0.2	5.3	5.5	5.7	5.1	-
*** Sundaram Ultra Short Term	2861.0	2416	1.3	0.2	5.3	5.8	6.0	5.3	1.28

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT TO SHORT TERM FUNDS

***** ICICI Pru Ultra Short to Short Term	587.1	21047	0.5	0.4	6.4	7.2	7.3	6.6	6.09
***** UTI Ultra Short to Short Term	3823.4	2680	0.4	0.3	6.2	7.0	7.2	7.4	7.12
***** Axis Ultra Short to Short Term	3329.9	4558	0.6	0.3	6.0	7.0	7.1	6.3	7.59
***** Bandhan Ultra Short to Short Term	41.4	6404	0.6	0.3	5.9	6.7	6.9	6.1	-
***** HDFC Ultra Short to Short Term	61.9	17793	0.9	0.4	5.8	6.6	6.8	6.1	11.75

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	
★★★★	HSBC Ultra Short to Short Term	30.8	875	0.8	0.3	6.0	7.4	7.4	6.4	7.56
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Ultra Short to ST	701.3	9727	1.0	0.4	5.4	6.4	6.5	5.9	7.94
★★★★	Canara Robeco Ultra Short to ST	45.3	1111	0.4	0.2	6.1	6.8	6.9	6.1	-
★★★★	DSP Ultra Short to Short Term	21.3	4750	0.5	0.3	5.8	6.6	6.8	6.1	-
★★★★	Invesco India Ult Shrt to Short Term	4061.7	1833	0.5	0.3	5.8	6.7	6.9	6.1	7.20
★★★★	JM Ultra Short to Short Term	39.8	215	0.7	0.3	5.7	6.7	6.8	6.0	3.48
★★★★	Mirae Asset Ultra Shrt to Short Term	2421.7	2434	0.7	0.2	5.7	6.6	6.8	5.9	6.15
★★★★	Nippon Ind Ultra Shrt to Short Term	4019.2	7933	0.8	0.3	5.8	6.8	6.8	6.1	5.09
★★★★	Tata Ultra Short to Short Term	4228.1	2871	0.5	0.2	6.1	6.8	6.9	6.1	4.04
★★★	Kotak Ultra Short to Short Term	3578.6	12093	1.0	0.3	5.6	6.6	6.7	5.9	8.77
★★★	LIC MF Ultra Short to Short Term	42.5	2010	0.4	0.2	5.9	6.6	6.7	5.9	5.21
★★★	Mahi Manu Ultra Short to ST	1751.4	535	0.9	0.3	5.7	6.5	6.6	5.8	12.86
★★★	SBI Ultra Short to Short Term	3737.0	11622	0.8	0.4	5.5	6.5	6.7	5.9	4.62
★	Baroda BNP Paribas Ultra Shrt to ST	42.9	382	0.9	0.2	5.6	6.4	6.6	5.8	-
★	Sundaram Ultra Short to Short Term	3693.0	446	1.0	0.3	5.3	6.3	6.5	5.8	1.42
DEBT - MONEY MARKET FUNDS										

India ‘needs new talent as it rapidly builds the semiconductor ecosystem’

SKILLS THE KEY. Industry expertise or expert bandwidth can be more valuable than funds in many cases

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

As India is getting into manufacturing sites and building semiconductor ecosystem for the first time, it needs to focus on process engineers, clean room technicians, equipment, technicians, wafer probing, material engineers in packaging, and many new skills that it does not have yet, experts said on Saturday.

Speaking at the Semicon India 2026 here, Manoj Choudhary, Vice- Chancellor of Gati Shakti Vishwavidyalaya said, “Many of the new skills that we have not done before 2021 because there was no semiconductor project set up in the country. And, therefore, while in these projects, we might have sent

many engineers abroad, whether to Taiwan or to Malaysia, as we set up more and more semiconductor projects under ISM 2.0, we need more and more people inside.”

Considering the future roadmap for devices and system, skilling has to be in alignment with the jobs, the kind of jobs that are needed within the fabs.

SPECIALISTS NEEDED
“In design, India is quite good like in IC design, but we also need to prepare people who are product specialist, who can create product definition and specification. People who can create system design and system architecture. That is something that we will be needed as India tries to become an *Atmanirbhar Bharat*,” he said adding that the focus should also



ADDRESS GAPS. Hands-on training is a big challenge that the semiconductor industry needs to address. **ANI**

be around value versus the volume.

Swaroop Ganguly, of IIT-Bombay said that very often the discussions with the industry and their partners is about funding for research, as it should be. Also, industry expertise or bandwidth can be more valuable than funds in

many cases. “When industry puts some of its small amount of bandwidth of some of its best experts on the table that can really enrich both research and talent development programmes,” he said.

The panellists agreed that the hands-on training

is another big challenge that is there in this industry. Therefore, that’s a really important ask of industry partners as well.

Similarly, Shankar Selvaraja of Indian Institute of Science (IISc) noted that the academic requirement and the industry requirements are not always on the same page.

“In terms of the baseline technical fundamentals that you want to incorporate, and what you need on the shop floor, they’re not necessarily the same. So, how do you work out a curriculum that will be beneficial on both sides? Based on that, we realise that maybe we need to have a bridge course for quick, on boarding of new recruits... the idea here is you work with the industry to develop what they are looking for,” Selvaraja added.

‘Talent makes India a global investment destination’

Our Bureau
Chennai

“India’s growth story is filled with opportunities and the next generation workforce talent makes it a global destination for investment,” said R Shankar Raman, President and Wholtime Director- Finance of Larsen & Toubro.

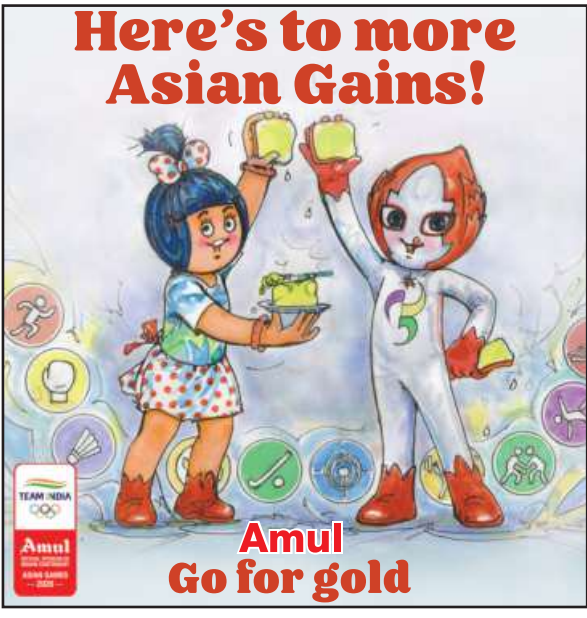
Delivering the 40th Convocation Day address at SAS-TRA Deemed University, Thanjavur, on Saturday, Raman outlined healthcare, education, public transport and utilities, semiconductor, water, defence and energy and environment as strategic areas of investment that shall leverage the bountiful demographic dividend of India.

Raman said there must be a coordinated effort between industry and academia to provide a balance between grounded knowledge in traditional disciplines and continuous learning in emerging technologies.

While the first degree is for first job, continuous learning is for the last job, said Raman. He urged graduates to be mentally agile and adaptable to face emerging challenges and be an integral part of nation building which offers a bouquet of career opportunities.

A release said that 4,414 students were conferred with various UG, PG and Ph.D. degrees.

The Founder Chancellor’s Best Ph.D. thesis award went to three scholars Hari Suthan, Anusree Sajeevan and Satya M from Engineering, Sciences and non-STEM disciplines. The Award for Overall Academic Excellence and the Silver Jubilee Alumni Award for the Best Outgoing Girl Graduate both went to Biyyappu Hari Keerthi of the B.Tech ECE programme, the release said.



India poised for decades of strong growth: N Chandra



N Chandrasekaran (right), Chairman, Tata Sons, and KV Ramani, Founder and Chancellor, Sai University **BIJAY GHOSH**

Our Bureau
Chennai

India is poised for strong economic growth over the next several decades, creating significant opportunities for the younger generation, said N Chandrasekaran, Chairman, Tata Sons, here on Saturday.

India is entering a period of economic growth that could be “unparalleled in our own history and unparalleled with any part of the world,” even as artificial intelligence, technology and regulatory change reshape the global economy, he said addressing the Sai University convocation. Chandrasekaran said the graduates were entering the workforce at a time of rapid technological, economic and regulatory change. While AI had raised concerns about job

losses, technology would also open up a range of new opportunities, he added.

Within five years there could be industries that do not exist today, along with new areas of employment, he added. Chancellor KV Ramani highlighted a shortage of quality higher education institutions in India and outlined the university’s founding purpose in addressing that gap.

businessline.

Disclaimer: Readers are requested to verify & make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser’s products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.

Why water could be the key to chip manufacturing

Our Bureau
New Delhi

India’s semiconductor build-out must factor in water recycling, chemical management and other sustainability safeguards at the design stage itself, as trying to retrofit these systems after fabrication plants become operational could prove significantly more difficult and costly, experts said at a panel discussion on Saturday at Semicon India 2026.

Indumathy Nambi of IIT-Madras, who moderated the session, said semiconductor manufacturing needs to be viewed through

its entire lifecycle, from design to disposal. She highlighted the large quantities of water, energy, chemicals and materials used by fabs and called for the recovery and reuse of materials rather than treating waste only at the end of the manufacturing process.

With semiconductor manufacturing requiring large volumes of ultra-pure water, energy and chemicals, the experts said sustainability cannot be treated as an add-on once production begins.

“Right now we are in a hurry to probably start with the production and if we do not incorporate this

during the design stage, it’s going to be even more technically and financially heavy to do those kind of retrofits,” said Prateek Bhatt, Business Director at Ecolab.

WATER CIRCULARITY
Bhatt said water could become a major constraint on the expansion of India’s semiconductor industry. A single mega fab can consume 10–15 million gallons of water a day, he said, warning that sourcing such volumes from groundwater would not be sustainable.

According to Bhatt, global water circularity in semiconductor manufac-

turing is currently 40–50 per cent, but the industry should aim for 80–95 per cent. He said technologies already exist to achieve higher levels of recycling, but they need to be incorporated into the design of individual facilities.

“The best way to do is to segregate the streams rather than blend them in the one place,” he said, explaining that separating wastewater streams makes it easier to treat and recycle them.

The need to plan for water management at the design stage is particularly important as semiconductor manufacturing processes become more ad-

vanced. Bhatt said that as chip node sizes decline, the number of rinses increases, meaning water consumption could rise further.

The panel also highlighted the challenges posed by chemicals used in semiconductor manufacturing, including per- and polyfluoroalkyl substances (PFAS), often referred to as “forever chemicals”.

Vaidya Bharadwaj of Tokyo Electron said PFAS is used across semiconductor equipment and that while existing safety practices can address exposure within manufacturing facilities, the longer-term environmental challenge remains difficult.

CELEBRATING THE QUIET DREAMERS WHO DRIVE POWERFUL CHANGE.



They are the visionaries who dream quietly and act with intent. Their steady pursuit of progress turns belief into action, and action into a future we can all look forward to.

The Hindu businessline Changemaker Awards 2026 celebrates these leaders of change, recognising the ones who challenge the ordinary and set in motion ripples that transform lives and communities.

Join us live as we applaud the changemakers shaping tomorrow.



CHIEF GUEST

Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman

Honourable Minister of Finance and Corporate Affairs, Government of India



Scan the QR code or visit thbl.news/BLCM2026 to subscribe and watch the event.



Presents



Powered by



September 22 | 6 pm onwards | New Delhi

Presenting Partner



Powered by



Associate Partners



Mobility Partner